NexKit
GLOBAL

ETHIOPIA EDITION
GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

THE PHONE-FIRST EDITION

07

The Remote Work Starter System

How to Build a Remote-Ready Profile and Find Online Work From Anywhere

Build the CV, profile and proof that get you past the first screen for a remote role.

10 remote roles | Remote-ready CV | Interview system

undefined	undefined	undefined
UNDEFINED	UNDEFINED	UNDEFINED

GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

The Remote Work Starter System

How to Build a Remote-Ready Profile and Find Online Work From Anywhere

COPYRIGHT, DISCLAIMER AND HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

Read This Page Before You Apply Anywhere

The Remote Work Starter System — How to Build a Remote-Ready Profile and Find Online Work From your country. First Edition · September 2026.

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was researched, written and edited by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It carries no individual author name and no personal credentials, because the value of the book is the method, not a personality.

Edition: First Edition · September 2026. Copyright in this edition rests with NexKit your country. Please do not redistribute the file. If a friend needs it, send them to the shop, not the PDF.

What this course is

A practical, your country-specific manual for becoming employable by a company that will never meet you in person. It maps ten remote roles against the skills you already have, shows how to write a CV and profile that survive an automated first screen, how to build proof when you have no remote experience, how to apply directly instead of only through job boards, how to handle a video interview on an unreliable connection, how to work across time zones, and exactly how money reaches a resident of a country with limited payment access when a foreign employer pays.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of a job, an interview or a reply. It is not legal, tax, immigration or financial advice. It is not a list of employers who hire where you live, because that list changes weekly and no verified version of it exists. It does not guarantee a visa, a contract, a salary or a payout method.

DISCLAIMER — READ THIS ONCE, PROPERLY

This course is **educational material only**. Nothing in it is a guarantee of income, and nothing in it is financial, legal or investment advice.

Any salary, rate or income figure in this book is a **target example or published benchmark, never a prediction about you**. local job advertisements frequently publish no salary at all, and where this book gives a range it says whether that range is published data or an estimate. Your outcome depends on your skills, your proof, your English, your time zone overlap, the employer and the market on the day you apply.

All prices, rates and ladders shown in this book are **illustrative examples** for teaching. You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of any platform you use, and the requirements of any bank, wallet or payment provider you deal with. Rules, fees, limits and country availability change, sometimes quickly.

Where the underlying research could not verify a fact, this book says so and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

DATES, CURRENCY AND EXAMPLES

All money in this course is US US dollars (USD), written as $25. Where a United States dollar figure appears it states its rate and its date on the same line.

Every business named anywhere in these pages is invented. Each is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. No real, recognisable local company is presented as a client, a case study or a testimonial.

Every figure cited is current as of **September 2026** unless a different date is printed beside it. Source URLs for those figures appear in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the back of the book.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON ANY OF THIS

Payment limits, wallet rules, tax thresholds and platform availability are the parts of this book most likely to go stale. Treat every number as a starting point for your own check, not as a substitute for it. Where this book names a rule, confirm the current version with the institution that made it.

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

01 · The Remote-Work Reality for locals 11
02 · Choose Your Role From Your Skills 15
03 · The Remote-Ready CV 20
04 · Your Professional Profile and Proof 28
05 · Finding and Applying to Remote Work 34
06 · The Remote Interview 42
07 · Remote Work Etiquette and Communication 50
08 · Time Zones, Schedule and Reliability 58
09 · Getting Paid by a Foreign Employer 64
10 · From Freelance to Remote, and the Two Plans 70

HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.

FRONT MATTER

Before You Start

This course teaches one job: getting hired by a company that will never meet you in person. Not a side gig, not a hustle — employment or a long retainer with an employer in another country, working from wherever you already live where you live.

What this course can help you do

— Work out which of ten remote roles fits the skills you already have, instead of the ones you wish you had.

— Write a one-page CV that survives an automated first screen built for a different country.

— Translate an local degree, a family business role, national service and volunteer work into language a foreign hiring manager reads without confusion.

— Build proof of work when you have no remote experience and no foreign references.

— Apply directly instead of only through job boards, using an application that takes 12 minutes rather than 90.

— Run a video interview from a room with unreliable power and a connection that drops.

— Work across time zones without wrecking your health or your family life.

— Understand exactly how money reaches a resident of a country with limited payment access when a foreign employer pays, and what the legal upgrade path looks like.

What this course cannot do

It cannot get you a job, an interview or a reply. It cannot promise a salary, a visa, a contract or a payment method. It is not legal, tax, immigration or financial advice. And it cannot give you a list of employers who hire where you live, because **no verified, maintained list of that kind exists** — anyone selling you one is selling you something they cannot keep current. This course teaches the system, not a list.

What you need

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT
An Android phone	Applying, messaging, most interviews, and several of the ten roles. Several sections of this course are written phone-first
A laptop, if you can borrow or share one	Five of the ten roles are effectively closed without one: designer, developer, researcher and most virtual-assistant work. Every section says plainly when a laptop is required rather than optional
A data bundle you can top up	A 2 GB monthly bundle sat at roughly $0.60 on an indicative published guide and 30 GB at roughly $5. Safaricom your country raised mobile data prices by an average of about 44% in December 2025; Ethio telecom held low-income bundles unchanged. Check your own operator before you plan a month
A professional email address	One address used for nothing except work. Section 04 shows how to set it up in ten minutes

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT
A Google account	Docs, Sheets, Drive for your samples and your tracker. Free, and it works on a phone

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT
A LinkedIn account	LinkedIn reported 1.80 m local members in late 2025, up 38.5% year on year. It is the surface foreign recruiters actually search

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT
A quiet corner and a door	Interviewers judge your background noise. A room you can close matters more than a good microphone
A notebook	Paper. Applications, follow-up dates and what each employer said. Section 05 gives you the columns

Time you actually need

Two phases, and they are different kinds of work.

90
MINUTES A DAY FOR 14 DAYS TO BECOME REMOTE-READY

45
MINUTES A DAY AFTER THAT, FOR APPLICATIONS

14 + 30
PREPARATION DAYS, THEN APPLICATION DAYS

The first 14 days build assets: role choice, CV, profile, proof, a tracker, and a rehearsed interview. The next 30 days are applications, follow-ups and interviews. If you spend the 14 days reading without producing a single file, you have not started. Section 10 lays both phases out day by day.

Tools, and the honest note about free plans

— **Google Docs and Sheets** — CV, tracker, research, invoices. Free, phone and laptop.

— **LinkedIn** — free profile. You do not need a paid plan to be found.

— **A free design tool** — only to export a clean one-page PDF CV. Do not design a decorative CV; see Section 03.

— **Grammarly or the spelling tools inside Docs** — free tiers. Useful for grammar, not for judgement.

— **Telegram or WhatsApp** — how most remote teams actually talk, and how you will stay in communities.

— **A PDF reader and a simple scanner app** — for signed contracts and ID documents when a legitimate employer asks.

— **A free password manager** — because you are about to hold accounts that matter.

> **FREE PLANS CHANGE**
>
> Free tiers, limits and country availability move constantly. Verify the current free limits before you build a workflow on any tool. Where this course mentions a platform, it says what is verified and what you must check yourself.

THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE

Apply before you feel ready. Readiness is not a feeling you arrive at. It is a set of files: a CV, a profile, three pieces of proof, a tracker and a rehearsed answer to four questions. Once those exist, you are ready, whether or not you feel it.

The people who get hired remotely are almost never the most qualified applicants. They are the ones who sent the twentieth application while everyone else was still rewriting the first. Your first ten applications will be bad. That is the price of the eleventh.

Two rules protect you while you apply. **Never pay anyone to be hired** — no equipment deposit, no training fee, no visa fee, no registration fee. And **never misrepresent yourself** — not your country, not your residency, not your experience. Both of those shortcuts end with you losing money or losing the role. Section 09 and the anti-scam section explain why in detail.

FRONT MATTER

Who This Is For, and Who It Is Not For

This is for you if

- You are roughly 21 to 35, where you live, and want to be paid by an employer abroad.
- You are a recent graduate, an under-employed professional, or a junior developer, designer, writer or administrator.
- You have a phone and can get access to a laptop for some hours each week.
- Your English is good enough to write a work message and be understood.
- You can give about 90 minutes a day for two weeks, then about 45 minutes a day.
- You accept that this is a search that may take months, not a switch you flip.

This is not for you if

- You want a guaranteed income, a guaranteed job, or a promise that this works.
- You want passive income. Remote employment is a job; it is measured like a job.
- You cannot answer messages within an agreed window most days.
- You are looking for someone to do the work for you — an agent who charges a fee to place you abroad is a scam pattern, not a service.
- You want to fake your location, rent an account or be paid in crypto. This course teaches none of that, and local rules prohibit parts of it outright.
- You are still deciding whether you want to work at all. This system rewards people who apply weekly.

ONE HONEST SENTENCE ABOUT WHY THIS IS HARD

> You are not competing against other locals. You are competing against every qualified applicant in every country where the employer can already pay easily. Your advantage is not price alone — it is reliability, overlap hours, clear writing and not disappearing. That is what the whole course builds.

FRONT MATTER

If You Only Have 5 Hours

Some readers will not do the 14 days. If that is you, do these five hours instead, in this order, and skip nothing.

1. **Hour 1 — Pick one role and stop browsing**
   Read the ten-role table in Section 02. Choose one primary role and one backup. Write both on paper. Every hour after this is spent on those two, not on ten.

2. **Hour 2 — Build the one-page CV**
   Use the annotated template in Section 03. One page, single column, no photo, no decoration. Save it as a PDF named Firstname-Lastname-CV.pdf.

3. **Hour 3 — Write the profile and the summary line**
   LinkedIn headline, About section, and the same three-line summary at the top of your CV. Section 04 gives the formula and the exact wording.

4. **Hour 4 — Build one piece of proof**
   One sample project, clearly labelled as a sample, in a public folder with view access on. One is enough to start. Section 04 shows the wording that keeps it honest.

5. **Hour 5 — Send five applications**
   Use the direct application email in Section 05. Five real applications, to five real postings, logged in the tracker. Then start the 45-minute daily habit and keep going.

> **WHAT YOU GIVE UP BY TAKING THE FAST PATH**
>
> You skip the interview rehearsal, the time-zone plan and the payment preparation. You will still need them — you will be learning them under time pressure, after an employer has already replied. That is a worse position than learning them now.

FRONT MATTER

The Honest Picture

Before you spend two weeks on this, look at the conditions you are working in. None of these numbers are reasons to stop. They are the constraints the rest of the course is built around.

Connectivity and devices

29.5 m
INTERNET USERS WHERE YOU LIVE — 21.7% OF THE POPULATION

9.80 m
SOCIAL MEDIA IDENTITIES — 7.2% OF THE POPULATION

9.37 Mbps
MEDIAN FIXED DOWNLOAD SPEED

26.63 Mbps
AVERAGE MOBILE DOWNLOAD SPEED, AUGUST 2025

Those two speeds look workable, and for most of the day they are. The number that decides whether you keep a remote job is the other one: **worst-case freelancer speeds as low as 98 Kb/s, with the worst window between 16:00 and 24:00**. That is the exact window in which a European or American employer wants to hold a call.

Smartphone ownership runs at about 15% of the population — 6% of women against 18% of men — so a phone is not a safe assumption for everyone reading this, even though almost every workflow in this course has a phone path. Median age is 19.1 and 24.3% of the population is urban. Most readers are young, and many are outside your city.

Sources: DataReportal Digital 2026: your country; Addis Fortune connectivity reporting; GSMA Mobile Gender Gap 2025 via Dollars Metrics. Full URLs in Sources.

What a local salary looks like

You need an anchor, so here is a real one. **Entry pay for a federal civil-service degree holder was raised to $70 a month from September 2025**, up from $45. At the 11 September 2026 rate of $161.10 per USD, that is about USD 71 a month.

ANCHOR	USD PER MONTH	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Federal civil service, degree-holder entry (from September 2025)	11,500	The honest benchmark most remote offers will be compared against by your family, and by you
Federal civil service scale minimum	6,000	The bottom of the formal public scale
Industrial-park garment worker	~1,800	What formal manufacturing entry work pays
Planning proxy for young urban white-collar work in Addis	6,000 – 15,000	An **estimate**, not a survey. Use it as a range, not a fact

Sources: Addis Standard via allAfrica, September 2025; wage.is; Numbeo your city cost-of-living page. your country has no universal statutory minimum wage for the private sector. local job boards do not publish salaries — postings say "Attractive" or "Negotiable".

READ THIS BEFORE YOU COMPARE ANY SALARY

A remote role advertised at USD 600 a month is roughly $96,660 at the 11 September 2026 rate — about eight times the civil-service entry figure. That comparison is real, and it is also incomplete. You will pay for your own data, your own power backup, your own equipment and your own quiet room, and you will carry the risk of a contract that ends. **Compare the net figure after your costs, not the headline figure.**

THE LIST THAT DOES NOT EXIST

There is no verified, maintained list of "employers who hire where you live". Employer policies, payment providers and country eligibility change weekly, and any list published today is wrong within a month. This course therefore teaches the system: how to find the roles, how to pass the screen, how to prove you can do the work, and how to get paid legally. If a paid product promises you such a list, treat the promise itself as the warning sign.

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Course

Ten sections, then reference material you will come back to. Read sections 01 to 04 with a document open, not a notebook.

Course objectives

1. Choose one primary and one backup remote role based on evidence about your own skills.
2. Produce a one-page CV, a LinkedIn profile, a portfolio and three pieces of labelled proof.
3. Run a 30-day application campaign with a tracker, a follow-up cadence and a named target.
4. Pass a remote interview on an unreliable connection without losing the role to a dropped call.
5. Work across time zones with a written reliability system you can explain to an employer.
6. Explain, accurately, how a foreign employer pays a resident of a country with limited payment access, and what you must never do.

Three ways to read it

01 Phone-first

Everything except the CV layout, long-form writing, design work and coding can be done on a phone. Where a phone is genuinely enough, the section says so. Where a laptop changes the outcome, it says that too, in plain words.

02 Low-data mode

Turn off autoplay and auto-download. Download the sections you are working on rather than streaming. Do document work offline and sync when you have signal. Budget your data like money, because in your month it is money — heavy freelancer data use has been reported at up to $19 a month.

03 Shared laptop

If you borrow a laptop for two hours, do not spend them reading. Spend them producing: build the CV, upload the samples, take the interview. Reading can happen on the phone.

04 Outside Addis

Nothing here requires you to be in your city. The only roles that favour Addis are ones where an employer wants an in-person meeting, and those are not remote roles. Regional cities often have more stable evening power and less congestion than the capital.

FRONT MATTER

The Words This Course Uses

Learn these twelve terms before Section 01. Half of the confusion in remote hiring comes from vocabulary, not from skill.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Remote	The work is done away from the employer's office. It does not mean flexible — most remote roles still have fixed hours.
Async / asynchronous	You and the other person do not have to be online at the same time. Work arrives as a written task, you reply when you pick it up.
Time-zone overlap	The hours when your working day and the employer's working day intersect. Most remote jobs need two to four hours of it.
Independent contractor	You are not an employee. You invoice the company, you handle your own tax, and you usually have fewer protections. This is the most common arrangement for hiring across borders.
ATS	Applicant tracking system. Software that reads your CV before a human does and sorts it into fields. Section 01 explains why this decides most applications.
Knockout question	A question in an application form that can remove you automatically — country of residence, right to work, time zone, salary expectation.
Take-home test	A short piece of real work an employer asks you to do before deciding. Agree the scope and whether it is paid before you start.
Trial period / paid trial	A short paid engagement, often one to four weeks, before a longer contract. Legitimate. Unpaid long trials are not.
Retainer	A fixed monthly fee for an agreed scope of work, usually as a freelancer. The bridge between freelance and employment.
Remittance corridor	A licensed channel through which money crosses a border — for example a licensed money-transfer operator paying out to an local wallet or bank account. Section 09 covers this properly.
Service exporter	An local business registered to sell services abroad and keep foreign-currency earnings. The legitimate upgrade path in Section 09.
TIN	Taxpayer Identification Number. Required where you live, and the first step on the upgrade path.

ONE THING TO UNLEARN NOW

Remote employers are not buying your time. They are buying finished work and the absence of surprises. Every section of this course is aimed at that one idea, and every template in it exists to make you look like the least surprising person in the pile.

01

SECTION ONE

The Remote-Work Reality for locals

What a foreign employer is actually buying when they hire someone they will never meet, why a machine reads your application first, the four routes through which remote hiring really happens, and the four honest blockers — payment rails, time zones, connectivity and country filters — each with the workaround that exists.

01 What a remote employer actually buys

02 Why the first screen is a machine

03 The four hiring routes

04 The honest blockers, and the workaround for each

05 What to do today

Most local applicants fail remote hiring for reasons that have nothing to do with ability. They apply through the wrong door, they write a CV built for a local reader, and they never address the four practical questions sitting in the employer's mind. This section fixes the map before you start walking.

1.1 What a remote employer actually buys

A manager abroad who hires you is taking a personal risk. If you fail, they have to explain to their own manager why they hired someone in another country whom nobody has met. That is the real decision being made. It is not "is this person clever" — it is "how likely is this to become my problem".

01 Reliable output

Work appears, finished, on the day it was promised, without anyone chasing you. In a remote team this is the single strongest signal, and it is available to a junior applicant with no foreign experience.

02 Overlapping hours

Two to four hours a day when you and the team are both online. your city is UTC+3 with no daylight saving, which puts you in a useful band for Europe, the Gulf and East Africa.

03 Clear written English

Not perfect English. Clear English. A short message that says what happened, what it means and what happens next. Section 07 is built on this.

04 Someone who does not disappear

You reply within the agreed window. You warn before a deadline slips, not after. You say when you do not understand. This is learnable in a week and it beats experience.

EXPLAIN An employer compares two candidates. One has stronger skills and a worse communication record. The other is slightly weaker but answers every message and finishes what they start. Remote teams choose the second candidate far more often than applicants expect.

An employer posts a part-time research role. One hundred and forty people apply. Two of them, on being asked a follow-up question by email, answer within four hours with a clear, short reply and a question of their own. One of those two gets the test task. Nothing about the other 138 was necessarily worse.

Write down the four items above. Against each, write the evidence you could show an employer in the next fourteen days. If a row is empty, that row is your work for this week.

You can name, for each of the four, one concrete thing an employer could see or read. "I am reliable" is not evidence. "I answered every message in the group project within a day for six months" is.

1.2 Why the first screen is a machine

Large employers do not read applications in order. They run them through an applicant tracking system — software that opens your CV, tries to extract your name, contact details, employers, dates, education and skills, and then ranks or filters the pile. A human sees perhaps the top slice.

This has three consequences you can act on, and one you cannot.

— **Act on it: layout.** A single-column CV with plain headings extracts cleanly. A two-column, graphic-heavy CV with text inside images extracts as noise, and unreadable text scores as missing text.

— **Act on it: wording.** If the posting says "customer support" and your CV says "client assistance", a keyword filter may not connect them. Use the employer's own nouns where they are true.

— **Act on it: the door.** A direct email to a named person at a growing company bypasses the system entirely. Section 05 shows how to do that without being rude or wasting the reader's time.
— **You cannot act on it: country filters.** Some employers set a residency requirement, or their payment provider cannot pay into your country, or the role is legally restricted to a country you are not in. That filter is invisible to you. Apply, and move on. Twenty applications exist precisely because some doors are locked from the inside and you will never hear why.

ANSWER KNOCKOUT QUESTIONS HONESTLY

Country of residence, right to work, time zone and salary expectation are usually required fields. Answer them truthfully. A lie here does not get you the job — it gets you a withdrawn offer, an unpaid invoice and, in the worst case, a fraud allegation. Section 09 covers the legal side.

1.3 The four hiring routes

Almost every remote hire arrives through one of four doors. Applicants who use only the first door apply ten times as often for the same result.

A Job boards

You apply to an advertised role and join a large pile. Slowest conversion, easiest to start, and good practice. Filter hard for roles marked as open to contractors worldwide, and read the eligibility line before you spend twenty minutes on the form.

B Direct application

You find a company that already hires remotely, and write to a real person about a real problem. No pile. Higher effort per application, much higher reply rate when the message is specific. Section 05 gives you the email.

C Referrals and communities

Someone inside a company mentions your name, or a community member forwards your profile. This is how most remote roles are actually filled. It requires you to contribute for weeks before you ask for anything.

D Freelance client to employer

You do paid work for a client, do it well for two or three months, and then ask for a retainer or a part-time contract. The employer already knows your work, so the risk question is already answered. Section 10 is built around this route.

THE ROUTE MIX THAT WORKS

For every ten applications you send, aim for roughly four from a job board, three direct, two through a community contact you have already helped, and one through a client or a client's referral. Adjust as the replies come in. What matters is that you are never running only one route.

1.4 The honest blockers, and the workaround for each

These four are real. Anyone who tells you they are imaginary has not tried to be paid in Addis for work delivered in London.

BLOCKER	HOW IT ACTUALLY SHOWS UP	THE WORKAROUND THAT EXISTS
Payment rails	You cannot hold a verified direct receiving account with the international payment services most employers use. Paying you becomes extra work for the employer's finance team, and some will decline on that basis alone.	Foreign earnings reach a resident of a country with limited payment access through an **your regulator-licensed remittance corridor** — the sender pays the transfer fee and the exchange spread, and you receive USD as cash, bank deposit or wallet credit. Ask about the payment route in the first conversation, not after the offer. Full detail in Section 09.

BLOCKER	HOW IT ACTUALLY SHOWS UP	THE WORKAROUND THAT EXISTS
Time zones	Addis is UTC+3. A US West Coast team's working day is your night. Employers who need live collaboration will hesitate.	Choose roles and employers where the overlap works in your favour: Europe, the Gulf, East Africa and Asia. Where you apply to the Americas, offer a written two-to-four-hour overlap window and an async-first working style you can prove. Section 08 has the table and the arithmetic.

BLOCKER	HOW IT ACTUALLY SHOWS UP	THE WORKAROUND THAT EXISTS
Connectivity	Median fixed download was 9.37 Mbps and average mobile 26.63 Mbps in the published figures, but worst-case freelancer speeds fall as low as 98 Kb/s, worst between 16:00 and 24:00 — exactly when foreign teams meet.	Text-first working, offline copies of everything you need, a written backup plan with a second SIM, a hotspot and a phone-call fallback, and a habit of testing the connection thirty minutes before anything that matters. Section 06 and Section 08 both build this.
Country filters	Some employers will not hire where you live, or their payment provider will not send there, or the role is restricted by where the company is registered. You usually will not be told.	There is no workaround inside the application. The workaround is volume and targeting: apply to companies that already hire independent contractors across many countries, and ask about the payment route early. **Never fake your country or residency.** That is the one shortcut that converts a rejection into a legal problem.

THREE THINGS THIS COURSE WILL NEVER TEACH YOU

Do not fake your country or residency. Do not use a VPN to open a foreign financial account. Do not rent, buy or borrow someone else's account or identity. Each of these is a way to lose an offer, lose money, or end up on the wrong side of local financial rules. Section 09 sets out what is verified and what is prohibited.

1.5 What to do today

1. Write the four things an employer buys, and one piece of evidence you already have for each.
2. Open five remote postings and read only the eligibility lines: country, time zone, contractor or employee. Write down which of the four blockers each one hits.
3. Decide which two of the four hiring routes you will run first. Write them in your notebook.
4. Do not apply yet. You will apply on Day 8 of the plan in Section 10, with assets behind you.

02

SECTION TWO

Choose Your Role From Your Skills

A working map of ten remote roles an local applicant can realistically enter — what the day looks like, the tools, the English level, whether a laptop is mandatory, the entry requirements and how the work is measured — followed by honest pay bands in USD with an USD conversion at the 11 September 2026 rate, and a self-assessment worksheet.

01 Start with evidence, not ambition

02 The ten roles, day by day

03 Entry requirements and pay bands

04 The self-assessment worksheet

05 How to research salary honestly

Ten roles are mapped here because ten is enough to cover almost every skill an local graduate or junior professional already has. You are going to choose one primary and one backup. Everything else in this course acts on those two.

2.1 Start with evidence, not ambition

Most applicants choose a role by what sounds impressive, then spend three weeks failing to build proof for it. Do it the other way round. Look at what you have already done — paid, unpaid, family, volunteer, academic — and find the role that your existing evidence already half-fits.

EXPLAIN Every role below is entered through proof, not credentials. A design role needs three visible pieces. A support role needs a written test. A developer role needs a repository. You are not choosing a career for life. You are choosing the door you can open in the next thirty days.

An applicant with a Management degree and two years in a family shop has evidence for customer support, virtual assistance and data entry. An applicant with a Computer Science degree and a half-finished GitHub profile has evidence for developer and data entry. An applicant with strong written the local language and English and a habit of writing long Telegram posts has evidence for content writing and social-media assistance.

List ten things you have actually done in the last three years that involved other people, a deadline or a finished document. Do not filter. You will match them against the table below.

For at least two of the ten roles, you can point to one item on your list and say "that is the same work". If you cannot do that for any role, your list is too short or too modest.

2.2 The ten roles, day by day

English levels use the common European scale. **A2** means you can read simple instructions and fill in fields. **B1** means you can write a clear routine message. **B2** means you can write a client-facing message or hold a real-time conversation without preparation. **C1** means you can write long-form work that reads naturally to a native reader.

ROLE	WHAT THE DAY LOOKS LIKE	ENGLISH	LAPTOP?	HOW THE WORK IS MEASURED
Virtual assistant	Inbox triage, calendar and bookings, supplier follow-ups, short research tasks, updating a shared sheet, chasing people who owe the client an answer.	B1 minimum, B2 comfortable	Yes, in practice. Many browser tabs and documents at once	Tasks completed on time, response time, error rate, how little the client has to think about you
Customer support agent	Answering tickets, chat and email using the client's templates, escalating real bugs, updating help articles, hitting first-response targets.	B2. You must handle an annoyed stranger in writing	Yes	First response time, resolution time, customer satisfaction score, tickets handled
Content writer	Research, outline, draft 800 to 1,500 words, revise from an editor's notes, upload into the client's publishing tool.	B2 to C1 written	Strongly preferred. Long-form drafting on a phone is slow and error-prone	Articles published per week, number of revision rounds, deadlines met

ROLE	WHAT THE DAY LOOKS LIKE	ENGLISH	LAPTOP?	HOW THE WORK IS MEASURED
Social-media assistant	Scheduling posts, replying to comments and messages from templates, sourcing images, pulling a short weekly numbers report.	B1 to B2	Helpful, not mandatory. Scheduling and replies work on a phone; design work does not	Posts shipped, reply time, engagement trend, follower growth

ROLE	WHAT THE DAY LOOKS LIKE	ENGLISH	LAPTOP?	HOW THE WORK IS MEASURED
Researcher	Structured desk research, building lead and competitor lists, source-checked summaries, cleaning messy data into a usable sheet.	B2 reading, B1 writing	Yes	Accuracy, completeness, turnaround, spot-check pass rate

ROLE	WHAT THE DAY LOOKS LIKE	ENGLISH	LAPTOP?	HOW THE WORK IS MEASURED
Designer	Working a request queue, resizing and adapting brand assets, social and web graphics, two or three feedback rounds per item.	B1 to B2. Mostly visual work	**Yes, mandatory.** Do not accept design work without one	Requests delivered, revision rounds, consistency with the brand guide
Developer	Tickets, branches, pull requests, code review, a short daily standup, debugging something that broke overnight.	B2 reading, B1 speaking	**Yes, mandatory**, plus a connection stable enough for repository sync and calls	Tickets closed, review quality, incidents caused, whether your code needs rework
Data-entry assistant	Entering records from documents or images into a sheet or system, removing duplicates, checking entries against a rule.	A2 to B1. Mostly reading fields	Yes for speed and safety. Some projects are workable on a phone with Sheets	Rows per hour, error rate, spot-check pass rate
Appointment setter	Working through a list, sending personalised openers, booking calls into the client's calendar, logging every contact.	B2 spoken. You will talk to strangers live	Yes for calling. Messaging-only setting is workable on a phone	Appointments booked and held, show-up rate, contacts worked per day
Sales development assistant	Building prospect lists, writing a researched first line, running follow-up sequences, keeping the system clean, handing qualified leads to a closer.	B2 to C1 written, B2 spoken	Yes	Reply rate, meetings booked, sequence completion, data quality

2.3 Entry requirements and pay bands

The pay column is an **estimate**, not published local data and not a promise. It reflects the entry-level range these roles commonly sit in for applicants paid in US dollars, before the employer's own market and seniority adjust it. Every figure must be replaced by the number in the employer's own posting and confirmed in conversation. The USD column is a straight conversion at **$161.10 per USD, the rate on 11 September 2026** — that rate moves, so reconvert before you plan anything.

ROLE	TYPICAL ENTRY REQUIREMENT	PAY BAND, USD/MONTH (ESTIMATE)	APPROX. USD AT 161.10
Data-entry assistant	An accuracy test on a fixed sample; basic spreadsheet skill	300 – 600	48,330 – 96,660
Social-media assistant	A sample calendar of ten posts for a fictional brand	400 – 900	64,440 – 144,990

ROLE	TYPICAL ENTRY REQUIREMENT	PAY BAND, USD/MONTH (ESTIMATE)	APPROX. USD AT 161.10
Appointment setter	A mock call or a scripted message test; often base plus commission	400 – 900	64,440 – 144,990

ROLE	TYPICAL ENTRY REQUIREMENT	PAY BAND, USD/MONTH (ESTIMATE)	APPROX. USD AT 161.10
Virtual assistant	A short intro video, a task test, sometimes a paid trial week	500 – 1,200	80,550 – 193,320
Content writer	Two or three writing samples in the client's subject area, plus a short test article	500 – 1,500	80,550 – 241,650

ROLE	TYPICAL ENTRY REQUIREMENT	PAY BAND, USD/MONTH (ESTIMATE)	APPROX. USD AT 161.10
Researcher	A sample research task with a fixed deliverable, such as 40 clean rows	500 – 1,200	80,550 – 193,320
Customer support agent	A written test and sometimes a mock ticket; typing accuracy matters	600 – 1,400	96,660 – 225,540
Designer	Three to five portfolio pieces and a paid test task	600 – 1,500	96,660 – 241,650
Sales development assistant	A three-email sample sequence written for a fictional company	600 – 1,500	96,660 – 241,650
Developer	A take-home task or a live coding test, plus a real repository history	800 – 2,500	128,880 – 402,750

Pay bands are **estimates prepared by the NexKit your country Editorial Team**, not survey data, not your local market data and not a forecast for you. USD-to-USD conversion at $161.10 per USD, the rate on 11 September 2026. The dollars moved 11.8% against the dollar over the preceding year, so this conversion will be wrong within months — reconvert at the current rate before you rely on it.

HOW TO READ A PAY BAND WITHOUT BEING FOOLED

A band is not an offer. The bottom of a band is what an employer pays someone with no proof and no competing offers. The top is what someone with three years of evidence and two competing offers gets. Your position inside the band is set by the proof in Section 04, not by the role you chose.

2.4 The self-assessment worksheet

Fill this in once, on paper or in a document. It takes about twenty minutes and it decides the next two weeks.

Skills I already have evidence for .....

Tools I can already use .....

Hours a week I can genuinely give .....

My quietest, most connected hours .....

My realistic connection quality .....

Primary role I am choosing .....

Backup role I am choosing .....

SCORE YOURSELF 1 (WEAK) TO 5 (STRONG)	1	2	3	4	5
Writing a clear message in English without help					
Speaking English with a stranger on a call					
Attention to detail on repetitive work					
Comfort with numbers and spreadsheets					
Working alone for a full day without supervision					
Asking for help early instead of late					

HOW TO READ YOUR OWN SCORES

If **writing** is 3 or above and **speaking** is 2, choose a written role: content writer, researcher, sales development assistant, or a support role that is ticket-based rather than phone-based. If **attention to detail** is 4 or 5, data entry and research will pay you faster than design will. If **asking for help early** is your weakest line, fix that before you apply anywhere — it is the single behaviour that most often gets a junior remote worker dismissed.

2.5 How to research salary honestly

local job advertisements frequently publish no salary at all. Postings say "Attractive" or "Negotiable", which tells you nothing and cannot be used to plan. For remote roles the same problem exists in a different form: the number is often absent from the advert, and public salary websites are thin on contractor roles outside a handful of countries.

So use three honest sources, in this order.

1. **The employer's own posting.** Where a range is published, that is data. Quoting it back in your application is neutral and professional, not greedy.
2. **The employer's own words in conversation.** Ask what range is budgeted for the role before you name a number, using the script in Section 06.
3. **Communities.** Ask people doing the same role in the same time zone what they are paid, in a community where you have already contributed. Ask about the range, not a single figure, and never repeat anyone's name next to a number.

DO NOT PLAN YOUR LIFE ON A PAY BAND FROM THIS BOOK

The bands in 2.3 are estimates. They exist so that you can tell an exploitative offer from a normal one. They are not a budget, a target or a promise, and they will be outdated by the time you read them.

03

SECTION THREE

The Remote-Ready CV

What a foreign employer screens for in eight seconds, the one-page rule, the summary-line formula, how to convert local education and experience into language a foreign screener understands, the achievements-not-duties rule with four before-and-after rewrites, and a full annotated template with a completed fictional example.

01 What the screener is looking for

02 The one-page rule and the summary line

03 Translating local experience

04 Achievements, not duties: four rewrites

05 Gaps, omissions, format and file naming

06 The annotated template

07 A completed example, fictional

Your CV has one job: to make a stranger in another country believe that hiring you is low-risk. Everything on the page either supports that belief or takes up space. This section removes the space.

3.1 What a foreign employer screens for

A first-pass reader gives a CV somewhere between eight and thirty seconds. In that time they are looking for four things, in this order: can this person do the tasks in my advert, can they communicate in writing, are they going to be reachable in my working hours, and is there anything here that will embarrass me later.

EXPLAIN None of those four questions is answered by a list of duties. "Responsible for" tells the reader what you were given. "Did X, which produced Y" tells them what happens if they hire you.

A CV that reads "Responsible for customer enquiries" is invisible. A CV that reads "Handled 40 to 60 customer enquiries a day by phone and Telegram for 14 months; kept a written log that the owner used to spot two recurring product faults" gives the reader a picture of a person who finishes things.

Open your current CV. Delete every line that starts with "Responsible for", "Duties included", "Helped with" or "Participated in". You will rewrite those lines in 3.4.

Every remaining bullet contains a number, a named tool, a named outcome, or a duration. If a bullet has none of those, it is decoration.

3.2 The one-page rule and the summary line

One page. Not because a longer CV is forbidden, but because a one-page CV forces you to choose, and choosing is what reads as confidence. The only exceptions are a developer with more than five years of real projects or an academic applying for research work.

The summary-line formula

Three lines under your name. Do not write an objective. Write what you do, what you have done, and what you are available for.

FORMULA: ROLE + EVIDENCE + AVAILABILITY

[Role you are applying for] with [number] [unit: months/years] of [the actual work]. I [one measurable thing you did]. Available [hours] hours a week, [overlap window] your city time (UTC+3), working as an independent contractor.

FILLED EXAMPLE — FICTIONAL APPLICANT

Customer support assistant with 14 months of front-line experience handling 40 to 60 written enquiries a day in English and the local language. I built the written reply templates that cut the average first response from six hours to under two. Available 30 hours a week with a four-hour overlap from 15:00 your city time (UTC+3), working as an independent contractor.

WHY THE AVAILABILITY LINE MATTERS MORE THAN YOU THINK

It answers the time-zone and payment questions before they are asked, in one sentence, without apologising. It also filters out employers whose hours will never work for you — which saves you weeks.

3.3 Translating local experience

A foreign screener does not know what a national service stint is, what a family business role involves, or what a university name signals. That is not prejudice; it is missing information. Your job is to supply it in their language without inflating anything.

WHAT YOU HAVE	WHAT TO WRITE	WHY IT WORKS
A degree from an local university	BA/BSc in `[subject]`, `[university]`, `[year]`. Add one line: the final-year project, in one sentence, with a number in it.	The screener needs to place the qualification. Naming the subject and year does that; the project line proves you can finish a piece of work and describe it plainly.
National service or a government placement	Write the role, not the programme: "Teaching assistant, `[place]`, `[dates]`. Taught `[subject]` to `[number]` students in `[number]` groups and kept the attendance and progress records."	Programme names mean nothing abroad. Transferable work does. Never leave a period unexplained if it lasted more than six months.
A role in a family business	Name it plainly: "Family retail business, `[city]` — `[what you did]`". Then the measurable outcome, and one sentence on who you reported to or worked with.	"Family business" does not read as a weakness here. Unexplained gaps do. Say it directly and give it a job title you actually held.
Volunteer work	Treat it exactly like paid work: organisation, role, dates, what you produced, how many people it affected.	It is the fastest way to show reliability and English communication when paid work is thin. Do not pad it, and do not dress it up as employment.

DO NOT TRANSLATE NAMES AWAY

Keep the real name of your university, your employer and your city. Translate the *work*, not the identity. "your city University" is a recognisable institution; "a leading national university" is not, and it reads as hiding something.

3.4 Achievements, not duties: four rewrites

Each pair below is a real shape of sentence an local applicant writes, and the same fact rewritten. The fact never changes. Only the framing does.

REWRITE 1 — SOCIAL MEDIA FOR A FAMILY SHOP

Before: Responsible for social media management for family business.

After: Ran the Facebook and Telegram pages of a family retail shop for 14 months. Grew the page from 0 to about 1,200 followers and answered roughly 30 customer messages a week, which the owner used to take pre-orders before stock arrived.

REWRITE 2 — ENCODING RECORDS IN AN OFFICE

Before: Worked as a data encoder at a government office.

After: Encoded 180 to 250 paper records a day into an Excel register for 11 months, with a spot-check error rate under 1%. The register became the office's reference for retrieving archived files.

REWRITE 3 — VOLUNTEERING

Before: Volunteered at a charity.

After: Volunteered six hours a week for eight months at a community learning centre. Taught basic computer skills to 24 students in four groups, wrote the lesson notes, and kept the attendance register the coordinator used for monthly reporting.

REWRITE 4 — A DEGREE WITH NO WORK EXPERIENCE

Before: Graduated with a BA in Management, 2024.

After: BA in Management, [university], 2024. Final-year project surveyed 60 small retailers in [city] on mobile-payment use; I designed the questionnaire, cleaned the responses in a spreadsheet and presented a written report to a panel of three lecturers.

THE HONESTY TEST FOR EVERY REWRITTEN LINE

Read the line out loud and ask: **could I show evidence for this if I were asked in an interview?** If the answer is no, the line is too strong, and it will cost you the role at exactly the wrong moment. Every number in these rewrites is something the applicant could count, describe or demonstrate.

3.5 Gaps, and what to leave off

Handling gaps

— **Under six months:** ignore it. Nobody counts months.

— **Six to eighteen months:** put a one-line entry in the same format as a job, with an honest label — family responsibilities, study, health, job search, self-directed learning. Add what you produced during it if you produced anything.

— **Over eighteen months:** same treatment, and prepare a spoken answer. The spoken answer matters more than the CV line. Section 06 gives the shape.

— **Never invent an employer or a date.** Remote employers do check, and a discovered fabrication ends the process permanently.

What to leave off a remote CV

Leave off

— A photograph. It is normal where you live and unusual abroad, and some systems discard files with images because they break parsing.

— Date of birth, marital status, religion, national ID numbers.

— Every school certificate back to Grade 9.

— Referees' phone numbers, unless asked. Write "References available on request".

— Software you have opened once. List only what you can do a task in.

— Two columns, icons, progress bars, coloured side panels.

Leave on, prominently

— City and country, because time zone and eligibility depend on it. Country is not optional.

— Professional email, a phone number with the country code, and a LinkedIn URL.

— One line stating you work as an independent contractor and which hours you can cover.

— Languages, with the honest level: the local language, English, and any other — say "professional working level" rather than a percentage.

— The portfolio link, on the first page, near the top.

3.6 File format and naming

1. **Build it in a document editor, not a design tool**
   Google Docs or Word, single column, one font, headings in bold. Design tools produce files that parse badly. If you want a designed version for a design role, keep a plain version too.

2. **Export to PDF, then check it on a phone**
   Open the PDF on your own phone. If you cannot read it without zooming, it is wrong. Most first-pass reading now happens on a small screen.

1. **Name the file properly**

   Firstname-Lastname-CV.pdf. No dates, no version numbers, no "final", no spaces. If you apply for two different roles, use Firstname-Lastname-CV-Support.pdf.

1. **Keep one master and tailor copies**

   Your master CV holds everything. Each application gets a copy where the top third is rewritten to match the advert. Never send the master unchanged and never lose it.

> **CHECK YOUR PDF ON SOMEONE ELSE'S PHONE**
>
> Export, then open the file on a different device from the one you made it on. Fonts, line breaks and images shift, and a CV that looks clean on your laptop can arrive as three and a half pages with the contact line on page two.

3.7 The annotated CV template

Copy this structure, replace every highlighted placeholder, and delete every annotation in brackets before you send it.

ONE-PAGE REMOTE CV — MASTER TEMPLATE

[FIRSTNAME LASTNAME]
[City], your country (UTC+3) · [+251 phone] · [firstname.lastname@email] · [linkedin.com/in/yourname] · [portfolio link]

SUMMARY
[Role] with [number] [months/years] of [actual work]. I [one measurable outcome]. Available [hours] hours a week with a [number]-hour overlap from [time] your city time, working as an independent contractor.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE
[Job or role title] — [Organisation, city] · [Month Year – Month Year]

- [What you did, with a number in it]
- [A tool you used and what it produced]
- [Something you improved, and the result]
- [Keep three bullets per role, four at most]

PROJECTS AND PROOF
- [Sample project name] — [one line on what it is and what you did]. Sample created for demonstration. [link]
- [Volunteer or pro-bono piece] — [what you produced and for whom].

EDUCATION
[BA/BSc subject], [University], [Year]. [Final-year project in one line, with a number].

TOOLS
[Tool] · [Tool] · [Tool] · [Tool] — list only what you can complete a real task in.

LANGUAGES
the local language (native) · English (professional working level: written and spoken) · [other].

AVAILABILITY
[Number] hours a week, [start time] to [end time] your city time, plus flexible hours for asynchronous work. References available on request.

3.8 A completed example

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

The CV below is invented to show the finished shape. The person, the employers, the university and the numbers are fictional. Do not copy the content; copy the structure.

EXAMPLE CV — FICTIONAL APPLICANT, CUSTOMER SUPPORT

HANNA BEKELE
a regional city, your country (UTC+3) · +251 9X XXX XXXX · hanna.bekele@email.com · linkedin.com/in/hannabekele · [portfolio link]

SUMMARY
Customer support assistant with 14 months of front-line experience handling 40 to 60 written enquiries a day in English and the local language for a regional retail business. I wrote the reply templates that cut the average first response from about six hours to under two. Available 30 hours a week with a four-hour overlap from 15:00 your city time, working as an independent contractor.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE
Customer Support Assistant — a national holiday Retail Trading, a regional city · March 2024 – May 2025

• Handled 40 to 60 customer enquiries a day across Telegram, Facebook Messenger and phone, in English and the local language, with a written log of every unresolved case.
• Wrote 22 reusable reply templates that reduced the average first response time from about six hours to under two.
• Kept a weekly sheet of recurring complaints; two product faults it identified were fixed by the supplier within the quarter.
• Trained one new colleague on the templates and the log, and wrote the one-page handover note still used for the role.

PROJECTS AND PROOF
• Support reply pack — a 15-template help-desk reply set written for a fictional online store, covering refunds, late delivery and damaged goods. Sample created for demonstration. [link]
• Community learning centre — volunteered eight months, taught basic computer skills to 24 students in four groups, and kept the attendance register the coordinator used for monthly reporting.

EDUCATION
BA in Management, a regional city Business College (example institution — fictional), 2023. Final-year project surveyed 60 small retailers in a regional city on mobile-payment use; I designed the questionnaire, cleaned 60 responses in a spreadsheet and presented a written report to a panel of three lecturers.

TOOLS
Google Sheets · Google Docs · Telegram Business · Meta Business Suite · typing at roughly 45 words per minute.

LANGUAGES
the local language (native) · English (professional working level: written and spoken) · Afaan Oromoo (conversational).

AVAILABILITY
30 hours a week, 09:00 to 20:00 a regional city time (UTC+3), plus flexible hours for asynchronous work. References available on request.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT, RUN THE FOUR CHECKS

- [ ] One page when opened on a phone.
- [ ] Every bullet has a number, a tool, a duration or a result.
- [ ] The availability line names the overlap window in Addis time and says "independent contractor".
- [ ] The file is named Firstname-Lastname-CV.pdf and every sample is labelled as a sample.

04

SECTION FOUR

Your Professional Profile and Proof

LinkedIn set up so that foreign recruiters find you, a professional email address and signature, a portfolio that works for non-designers, what a recruiter actually looks at on GitHub, and how to build three pieces of credible proof when you have no remote experience — with the exact wording that keeps every sample honest.

01 LinkedIn, set up for discovery

02 Email address and signature

03 A portfolio for non-designers

04 GitHub, and what recruiters read

05 The work-sample folder

06 Proof with no remote experience

07 How to label a sample honestly

A CV is a claim. A profile is a claim that other people can check. This section builds the checkable half of your application: a profile that appears in search, a portfolio that opens in one tap, and three pieces of work that are honestly labelled.

4.1 LinkedIn, set up for discovery

LinkedIn reported 1.80 m members where you live in late 2025, up 38.5% year on year — one of the fastest-growing member bases in the region. That growth is not the reason to be there. The reason is that foreign recruiters and small-company founders search LinkedIn by keyword, country and time zone, and if you are not indexed for the right keywords you do not exist to them.

The five fields that decide whether you are found

FIELD	WHAT TO WRITE	COMMON MISTAKE
Photo and banner	A clear head-and-shoulders photo against a plain wall in daylight. A simple banner with your role in large text.	A cropped group photo, or no photo at all. Both reduce replies.
Headline	The role you want plus the tools and the hours. `[Role] | [tool] | [time overlap]`	Writing your current job title instead of the role you are applying for.
About	Three short paragraphs: what you do, one piece of evidence with a number, and how to reach you and when.	An empty About, or a copy of the CV pasted without line breaks.
Location	Your real city and your country. Do not change it.	Setting the location to London or Dubai. Recruiters check, and it ends the conversation.
Open to work	Turn on the recruiter-visible setting for the specific role titles you chose in Section 02.	Leaving it off, then wondering why nobody writes.

COPY-READY: ABOUT SECTION

I am a **[role]** based in **[city]**, your country, working as an independent contractor.

For the last **[duration]** I have **[the actual work, in one sentence]**. **[One measurable result, with a number]**. I work in **[tools]** and I am comfortable with **[one more tool]**.

I am available **[hours]** hours a week, with a **[number]**-hour overlap with **[employer region]** from **[time]** your city time (UTC+3). The fastest way to reach me is **[email]**. Samples of my work: **[link]**.

CONTRIBUTE BEFORE YOU ASK

Comment usefully on five posts a week in your chosen field — a specific observation, not "Great post". By the time you send a connection note to someone, your name should already look familiar in their notifications. This is the mechanic behind route C in Section 01.

4.2 A professional email address and signature

Your email address is the first thing a screener sees after your name, and it is the cheapest thing on this list to fix. Do it today.

— **Good:** `hanna.bekele@` a mainstream free provider. **Bad:** nicknames, numbers that look like a birth year, jokes, or anything with more than one dot.
— **One address for work only.** Not the one you use for Telegram groups, shopping or forums. You will be sharing this address with employers and it will collect their messages.
— **Turn on two-step verification** on the email account itself, and never share a one-time code with anyone. No legitimate employer, bank or platform asks for your one-time code — that request is always a scam.

COPY-READY: EMAIL SIGNATURE

[Firstname Lastname]
[Role] · [City], your country (UTC+3)
[email] · [+251 phone]
[LinkedIn URL] · [portfolio link]

Keep it to four lines. Do not add quotes, images, coloured backgrounds or a logo you do not have.

4.3 A portfolio for non-designers

You do not need a website. You need one link that opens in a browser on a phone and shows three pieces of work with a plain explanation each. Writers, researchers, support applicants, assistants and sales applicants all need this as much as designers do.

1. **Create one folder in a free cloud drive**
   Name it `Firstname Lastname — Work Samples`. Inside it, one sub-folder per sample. Put a one-page PDF in each sub-folder explaining the brief, what you did, what the result was, and the word SAMPLE on the cover.

2. **Set sharing to "anyone with the link can view"**
   View only. Never edit access. Test the link in a private browser window on a phone, and test it while logged out, because that is how an employer will open it.

3. **Write a one-page index as the first file**
   Number the samples, give each a one-line description and a link, and put your contact details at the top. Name it `00 — Start Here` so it sorts first.

4. **Compress before you upload**
   Large images and video are expensive on a phone bundle and slow to open. Keep each file under a few megabytes, and prefer PDF and plain text over video unless the role is video work.

LOW-BANDWIDTH CHECK

Open your own portfolio link on mobile data with images set not to load automatically. If the employer cannot understand your samples without downloading a large file, they will close the tab. A text-first index with small images beats a beautiful gallery that takes ninety seconds to load.

4.4 GitHub, for developers

If you are applying for developer work, your GitHub profile is read more carefully than your CV. What a reviewer actually looks at, in order:

1. **Your profile page.** A real name, a one-line description, a location, and a link. An empty profile with three forks reads as abandoned.
2. **Pinned repositories.** Three or four, chosen by you. Each needs a README that says what the project does, how to run it, and what you would do differently next time.
3. **Commit history on your best repository.** They are looking for steady work over weeks, not one dump of files. Small regular commits beat one large upload.
4. **Whether the code runs.** A reviewer will try. A project with setup instructions that work is worth more than a more impressive project that does not.
5. **How you write and respond in issues and pull requests.** This is where they judge whether you will be straightforward to work with remotely.

> **A FIRST REPOSITORY THAT IS BETTER THAN A TUTORIAL CLONE**
>
> Solve a small problem you actually have: a script that renames your downloaded files, a page that calculates something you calculate by hand, a small tool that reads a spreadsheet and produces a summary. Then write a README a stranger can follow. One such repository, finished and documented, outperforms five half-built tutorial projects.

4.5 The work-sample folder

Separate from the public portfolio, keep a private folder you can send on request after an interview. It should hold the things that are useful but not public: a longer writing sample, a spreadsheet you built, a process document you wrote, a design file, a short recording of you explaining your work. Employers ask for this often, and having it ready the same day is a visible advantage.

Longest writing sample I have .....

The spreadsheet or document I am proudest of .....

A process I documented for someone else .....

A recording of me explaining my work .....

4.6 Proof with no remote experience

This is the wall most local applicants hit: every posting asks for experience you cannot get without being hired. The answer is not to wait. It is to build three things that behave like experience, and to label them accurately so that nobody feels misled.

PROOF TYPE	WHAT TO BUILD	TIME	WHAT IT PROVES
Sample project 1	A finished piece of work in your primary role, made for an invented business, with a written brief you set yourself and a labelled deliverable.	1 day	You can produce the output the role produces.
Sample project 2	The same role, different industry, and deliberately harder — tighter deadline, more data, or an awkward constraint.	1 day	You can repeat it, not only do it once.
Sample project 3	The same role again, but with a revision round. Ask someone to criticise the first version and record what you changed.	half a day	You can take feedback, which is the thing remote managers worry about most.
Volunteer or pro-bono piece	Real work for a real organisation — a community centre, a church, a school, a local non-profit, a small shop run by someone you know — done free, with permission to describe it.	1 to 3 weeks	You work with real people, real deadlines and real consequences.
Documented personal project	Something you built or ran for yourself, written up honestly: what the problem was, what you did, what happened, what you would change.	1 day to write up	You can explain your own work in writing, which is the whole job remotely.

PRO-BONO WORK HAS ONE RULE

Agree the scope in writing before you start, including the number of revision rounds, and ask for permission to describe the work and to show the output. One clearly-scoped free project that you finish is worth more than three open-ended favours that drag on and produce nothing you can show.

4.7 How to label a sample so nothing is misrepresented

Every sample you produce for an invented business carries a label. This protects you in an interview, when someone asks "who was this client?" — and it protects you legally, because presenting invented work as real is a misrepresentation that can end a contract.

COPY-READY: THE STANDARD SAMPLE LABEL

Sample — created by [your full name] **for demonstration.** This work was produced for a fictional business as an example of my [role] work. It was not commissioned by a client.

COPY-READY: DESCRIBING A SAMPLE IN A CV OR MESSAGE

Self-directed sample project — [name]. I wrote a [deliverable] for a fictional [business type], working from a brief I set myself that matched a real posting I found. It took [time] and produced [output]. Sample created for demonstration; not client work.

COPY-READY: DESCRIBING A REAL VOLUNTEER PIECE

Volunteer work — [organisation], [city], [dates]. Unpaid. I [what you did], which produced [output]. [Name] at the organisation can confirm this if needed.

THE LINE YOU DO NOT CROSS

Never present a sample as client work, never invent a client name, and never use a real company's logo in a sample. If an employer discovers that a "client project" was fictional, you lose the role and the reference. The label above costs you one line and removes the entire risk.

05

SECTION FIVE

Finding and Applying to Remote Work

The four hiring routes in operational detail — job boards and how to filter them, direct applications to a company careers page, referrals inside local and diaspora communities, and converting a freelance client into an employer — followed by the application system itself: a tracker with exact columns, the 20-application rule, a tailored application that takes 12 minutes instead of 90, and a follow-up cadence that stops before it becomes harassment.

01 Route A: job boards, filtered properly

02 Route B: the direct application

03 Route C: referrals and communities

04 Route D: converting a client into an employer

05 The application tracker

06 The 20-application rule

07 The 12-minute tailored application

08 The follow-up cadence

09 Copy-ready messages

Everything before this section was preparation. This is the part that produces replies. It is deliberately mechanical, because the applicants who get hired are not the ones with the best instincts — they are the ones running a system they can repeat on a bad week.

5.1 Route A: job boards, filtered properly

Job boards are where you start, not where you finish. The advantage is volume and the disadvantage is that everyone else has the same access. The filtering is what separates a wasted twenty minutes from a live application.

This book does not name specific boards as sources of local-eligible roles, because eligibility rules change and a board that accepted local contractors last year may not this year. What follows is the filter that works on any board.

1. **Filter by region before you read a single job description**
   Most large boards let you filter for roles open worldwide, or for a region. Use that filter first. Then check whether the region list actually includes Africa or "anywhere". If a role is restricted to a country or a union you are not in, close it immediately. Do not spend twenty minutes on a role you cannot legally be paid for.

2. **Read the eligibility paragraph, not the responsibilities**
   Open every posting at the bottom, where location, contract type and "you must be eligible to work in..." usually sit. That paragraph decides whether the rest of the advert is worth reading.

3. **Filter for contract, not only remote**
   "Remote" often means remote within one country. Look for the words that describe hiring an independent contractor anywhere. If the advert says "employee" and names a country's employment law, you are unlikely to be able to take it.

4. **Filter by your overlap, not by your preference**
   Sort the survivors by required working hours. A role needing four hours of overlap with a European team is achievable from Addis. A role needing live coverage of a US West Coast afternoon is a night shift. Decide honestly whether you will still be doing it in month four.

5. **Sort by posting date and work the newest first**
   An application sent in the first 48 hours of a posting is read by a human far more often than one sent in week three. Work the newest postings, every day, for thirty minutes, rather than batching them at the weekend.

> **THE BOARD HABIT THAT ACTUALLY WORKS**
>
> Thirty minutes a day, newest first, five applications a week. Not a four-hour session on Sunday. Remote hiring moves in days, and a role you find on day one is worth ten you find on day nine.

5.2 Route B: the direct application

A direct application is an email or a form submission to a specific company that already hires people remotely, written about a specific problem, addressed to a person.

It bypasses the pile entirely. The cost is research; the return is a reply rate several times higher than a board application.

How to pick ten companies worth a direct application

1. Look at companies you already know something about — a tool you use, a product you have bought, a publication you read, an organisation whose work you understand.
2. Check whether they already hire remotely. Evidence: a careers page with remote roles, team members listed in several countries, or a public statement about distributed work.
3. Check whether they already pay people outside their own country. This is the question that matters most, and it is answered by where their contractors live.
4. Write down a real, specific problem you can see from the outside: a help page that is out of date, a support queue with a slow public response time, a blog that has not been updated, a product page with unclear pricing, a job advert they have been re-posting for months.
5. Send one email. Not three. Not a follow-up to four different addresses.

> **THE RULE THAT KEEPS DIRECT APPLICATIONS HONEST**
>
> Only describe a problem you have actually observed, from information the company has published. Do not invent a bug, do not claim to have inside knowledge, and do not pretend you are a customer if you are not. A single invented detail turns a confident message into a dishonest one.

5.3 Route C: referrals and communities

Most remote roles are filled before or shortly after they are advertised, through someone inside the company knowing a name. You cannot manufacture that, but you can put yourself in the rooms where it happens — and you can be useful first.

Where the rooms are

— **local professional groups on Telegram and LinkedIn.** Developers, designers, writers, accountants and graduates all have groups. Some are noise; a few produce real leads. Join five, watch for two weeks, then start contributing.

— **Diaspora communities.** locals working abroad are often the ones asked "do you know anyone?" They are also the people who understand both your context and the employer's. Treat them as colleagues, not as sponsors.

— **Professional communities around your specific tool or role.** Support professionals, researchers, technical writers and developers all have communities organised around tools, and those communities are where hiring managers say "we are looking for someone" before the advert exists.

— **Open-source and volunteer projects.** The slowest and most reliable route. Three months of steady contribution to a project produces a reference that a stranger cannot fake.

How to contribute before you ask

01 Answer questions in your area

Answer two questions a week that you actually know the answer to. Short, specific, with the reason. This is how your name becomes recognisable.

02 Share something you made or found

A sample, a template, a link with a sentence explaining why it matters. Not self-promotion; contribution.

03 Ask for information, not for a job

"What does the hiring process look like at your company?" gets an answer. "Can you refer me?" usually does not.

04 Ask for the referral last

After weeks of visible contribution, and only with a specific role and a tailored CV to point at. Keep it small: one link, one sentence, no pressure.

WHAT A REFERRAL IS NOT

A referral is not a favour you are owed, and a community is not a job board with extra steps. If your only messages in a group are requests, people stop reading them — and the group notices faster than you think.

5.4 Route D: converting a freelance client into an employer

The easiest employer to get is one who has already paid you. They know how you work, they know whether you disappear, and they have already solved their payment problem because they have already paid you once. Section 10 covers the full transition; this is the mechanic in brief.

- Deliver two or three months of work without a single missed deadline before you raise anything.
- Keep a written record of what you produced, so the conversation is about evidence rather than impression.
- Ask for a fixed monthly retainer with a defined scope, not more hours at the same rate. A retainer is the bridge between gigs and employment.
- Only after a retainer is running well, ask whether they would consider a part-time contract with set hours, a title and a place in the team.

5.5 The application tracker

Twenty applications with no record is twenty applications wasted, because you will not know who to follow up with or what each one said. One spreadsheet, twelve columns, updated the same day.

COLUMN	WHAT YOU ENTER	WHY IT EARNS ITS PLACE
1. Date applied	The day you sent it.	Drives your entire follow-up cadence.
2. Company	The real company name.	You will apply to some companies twice for different roles.
3. Role title	Exactly as advertised.	Lets you reuse the tailored wording if a similar role appears.

COLUMN	WHAT YOU ENTER	WHY IT EARNS ITS PLACE
4. Route	Board, direct, referral or client.	Tells you after twenty applications which route is actually working for you.

COLUMN	WHAT YOU ENTER	WHY IT EARNS ITS PLACE
5. Posting link	The full URL, saved.	Adverts get taken down. You need the text when they reply.

COLUMN	WHAT YOU ENTER	WHY IT EARNS ITS PLACE
6. Contact	The name and channel of any human you reached.	Named follow-ups get answered; generic ones do not.

COLUMN	WHAT YOU ENTER	WHY IT EARNS ITS PLACE
7. Stated pay	The number in the advert, or "not stated".	Stops you re-entering a conversation about money you already know.
8. Payment route	What they said about how they pay contractors.	The single most common late-stage blocker. Ask early.
9. Time zone and overlap	Their time zone and the overlap they need.	Prevents you accepting something you cannot sustain.
10. Status	Sent, viewed, interview, test, offer, rejected, no reply.	Keeps the pipeline honest when you feel like nothing is happening.
11. Next action date	The date you will follow up or chase.	The column that actually gets people hired.
12. Notes	One line on what they said and what they care about.	You will interview weeks later and remember nothing.

KEEP THE TRACKER ON YOUR PHONE

Use a free spreadsheet app so you can open it anywhere. If your only copy lives on a laptop you borrow twice a week, the tracker stops being updated and the system collapses. The tracker is the system.

5.6 The 20-application rule

Send twenty high-quality applications before you draw any conclusion about whether this works. That is roughly five a week for four weeks, or one a working day for a month.

TARGET EXAMPLE — NOT A PREDICTION

`20 applications ÷ 30 days ≈ 5 per week`

Twenty applications do not guarantee an interview, and this course will not tell you what percentage to expect. Conversion depends on your role, your proof, your English, the market that month and luck. Twenty is the number at which you have enough data to change something, instead of guessing.

What "high quality" means here is specific, and it is not "long".

- [ ] The role genuinely matches your primary or backup role from Section 02.

- [ ] You read the whole posting, including the eligibility paragraph.
- [ ] The top third of your CV and your summary line were rewritten for this posting, using its own nouns where they are true.
- [ ] You answered every knockout question honestly.
- [ ] You attached exactly one PDF, correctly named.
- [ ] You logged it in the tracker with a next action date.
- [ ] Where a human contact existed, you sent one short message to them separately from the form.

WHAT DOES NOT COUNT

Twenty applications is not twenty clicks on a "quick apply" button with the same CV. It is not twenty messages to strangers asking for work. It is not ten applications sent three times. If you cannot describe the job you applied to a week later, it did not count.

5.7 The 12-minute tailored application

Tailoring feels like it should take ninety minutes. It takes twelve if you have already done the work in Sections 03 and 04, because you are not writing from scratch — you are swapping the top third.

1. **Minutes 1 to 4 — read and highlight**
   Read the posting properly. Highlight five phrases: the role title, two responsibilities, one tool and one outcome they say they want. Those five phrases are your vocabulary for the next eight minutes.
2. **Minutes 5 to 7 — rewrite the top third**
   Open your master CV copy. Rewrite the summary line using the formula from Section 03. Reorder your three strongest bullets so the most relevant one is first. Change nothing else.
3. **Minutes 8 to 9 — write three lines to a human**
   If there is a named person or a contact address, write three lines: why this role, one line of evidence, one line of availability. If there is no human, write a short cover note into the form field.
4. **Minutes 10 to 11 — fill the form honestly and completely**
   Answer every field. Leave no blank that can be filled. Name your country and time zone without apology. Do not paste a long cover letter into a short field.
5. **Minute 12 — log it and set the next action**
   Tracker updated, next action date set four days out. Then close the tab and move on. The next application is worth more than a tenth revision of this one.

ONE PDF, EVERY TIME

Send a PDF, not a Word file, not an image, not a link to an editable document. Word files reformat on other machines and images cannot be read by screening software. If a form will not accept a PDF, paste the text plainly into the field and attach nothing.

5.8 The follow-up cadence

Follow-up is where most applicants lose the role by doing nothing, and a smaller number lose it by doing too much. Four touches is the ceiling. After that you stop, and you record it as a no.

WHEN	WHAT YOU SEND	WHY THIS TIMING
Day 0	The application itself.	Newest postings get read first. Send within 48 hours of the advert appearing.
Day 4	A two-line follow-up that adds one thing: a sample relevant to their advert, or an answer to something they asked.	Long enough that you are not pushy, short enough that you are still in the pile.
Day 11	A three-line follow-up offering a specific next step: a short call, a small paid test, a walkthrough of your samples.	Gives the reader something small to say yes to.
Day 21	A closing note: you remain interested, you are applying elsewhere, you would welcome a reply either way.	Ends the loop politely. Sometimes produces a reply precisely because it closes.
Day 22 onward	Nothing. Mark it closed in the tracker.	Chasing past four touches damages your reputation in small industries, and small industries are where remote work lives.

Send on working days, in the employer's time zone. Not on a Friday evening, not at the weekend, and never twice in one day.

5.9 Copy-ready messages

COPY-READY: DIRECT APPLICATION EMAIL

Subject: [Role title] — [Your name], [city], your country (UTC+3)

Hello [name, if you have it — otherwise "Hello"],

I am applying for the [role title] role. I am a [role] based in [city], your country, working as an independent contractor.

Your posting mentions [one specific thing from the advert]. In my last [duration] I [one line of directly relevant work, with a number]. A sample of the same kind of work is here: [link]. It is labelled as a sample created for demonstration.

I can cover [hours] hours a week with a [number]-hour overlap from [time] your city time, and I am used to working from written briefs. My CV is attached as a one-page PDF.

If it is useful, I can complete a short paid test task so you can see the work rather than read about it.

Thank you for your time.
[Your name]
[email] · [phone with country code] · [LinkedIn]

COPY-READY: LINKEDIN CONNECTION NOTE

Hello [name] — I work as a [role] in [city], your country, and I have been following [company] because of [one specific, true reason]. I am not asking you for a referral. I would like to stay connected in case something relevant opens on your team. My work samples are here if they are ever useful: [link].

COPY-READY: FOLLOW-UP AFTER NO REPLY, DAY 4

Subject: Re: [Role title] — [Your name]

Hello [name],

Following up briefly on my application for [role] on [date]. Since sending it I finished a [short description of a sample] that matches the [specific task] in your posting: [link].

No reply needed if the role is filled. I will keep it short from here.

[Your name]

COPY-READY: CLOSING NOTE, DAY 21

Subject: Closing the loop — [Role title]

Hello [name],

I applied for [role] on [date] and have not heard back, which is completely normal and needs no explanation. I am still interested, and I am also applying elsewhere, so I wanted to close the loop rather than keep chasing.

If the role is still open and you would like a short paid test task, I am available this week. Either way, thank you for considering the application.

[Your name]

THE NUMBER THAT MATTERS THIS MONTH

Not replies. Not interviews. **Applications sent and logged.** You control that number completely, and everything else follows from it. On a week when nothing is landing, the only useful question is "how many went out, and were they tailored?"

06

SECTION SIX

The Remote Interview

Setting up a room with unreliable power and an unstable connection, what to test beforehand, a four-layer backup plan that ends in a phone call, the four question types you will be asked with STAR answers built on local examples, how to describe your connection without sounding like a risk, how to handle a technical test and a salary question, and the questions you should be asking them.

01 The room, and what to test

02 The four-layer backup plan

03 The four question types, with STAR answers

04 Talking about your connection

05 The technical test

06 Salary questions and how to answer them

07 Questions you should ask

08 Checklists and copy-ready messages

A remote interview is not a harder interview. It is the same interview with an extra failure mode: the technology. You cannot control the grid. You can control everything around it, and most applicants do not, which is why being prepared is worth more here than being impressive.

6.1 The room, and what to test

Choose the room a day in advance, not an hour before. The requirements are boring and they matter: a door that closes, a wall behind you rather than a window, light on your face rather than behind your head, and a power socket within reach of your charging cable.

TEST	WHEN	WHAT "PASS" LOOKS LIKE
The meeting link	The day before, and again 30 minutes before	The link opens, asks for your name, and shows you a preview of yourself.
Camera and microphone	With a friend, at the same time of day as the interview	They can see your face and hear you clearly without you shouting.
Upload speed, not download	In the same room, at the same hour	Video holds steady for two minutes. Note that published worst-case freelancer speeds fall as low as 98 Kb/s between 16:00 and 24:00 — test in your real interview window, not at 09:00.
Power	Before every interview	Laptop and phone above 80%, charger plugged in, and a charged power bank within reach.
Background	Once, with a screenshot	Nothing private, nothing distracting, nothing moving behind you.
Noise	At the interview hour	You can hear yourself think. If not, find another room or another hour.

JOIN TWO MINUTES EARLY, WITH YOUR NOTES ON PAPER

Two minutes early is early enough to look organised and late enough not to sit alone for ten. Keep your notes on paper beside you, not on screen — glancing down at paper looks like thinking, and glancing at another window looks like reading.

6.2 The four-layer backup plan

Do not plan one backup. Plan four, and tell the interviewer you have them before the interview starts. That single sentence converts "this candidate might drop" into "this candidate has thought about it".

1. **Layer 1 — Your primary connection**
   Your normal line, in the room you chose, with the device plugged in. Nothing clever. This layer works most of the time.

2. **Layer 2 — A second SIM on a different network**
   A cheap second SIM from a different operator, kept topped up and tested. When one network is congested or down, the other is often fine, because they fail separately. This is the highest-value item in the whole plan.

1. **Layer 3 — Phone hotspot, and a neighbour's connection**

   Your phone's hotspot as a fallback for the laptop. If a neighbour or a nearby family member has a working line and you have asked them in advance — not on the day — that is a legitimate third option. Ask once, and be clear about how long you need.

1. **Layer 4 — Phone call, and a written summary**

   Agree a phone number in advance by email: "If my video drops I will call this number within one minute." A voice call uses almost no data and works when video does not. If even that fails, send the message in 6.7 within ten minutes.

COPY-READY: THE MESSAGE YOU SEND BEFORE THE INTERVIEW

Hello [name],

Looking forward to speaking at [time] [their time zone], which is [time] in your city.

One practical note. My main connection is [network] and I also have a second network and a phone hotspot ready. If the video drops at any point, I will call [number] within one minute, and if that does not connect I will email you straight away. Nothing about the conversation needs to be lost.

[Your name] · [phone]

WHAT NOT TO DO WHEN THE CONNECTION DROPS

Do not keep re-joining and leaving repeatedly. Do not send six messages. Rejoin once; if it fails again, switch to layer 2. If the call is lost entirely, call the agreed number, and if that fails, send the written summary in 6.7. One calm sequence beats ten panicked reconnections.

6.3 The four question types, with STAR answers

Almost every remote interview is built from four kinds of question. Prepare one answer for each kind and you will never be silent. STAR means Situation, Task, Action, Result — and for remote roles the Result is the part that gets you hired.

Type 1 — Tell me about yourself

This is not an invitation to tell your life story. It is a sixty-second summary with three parts: what you do now, one piece of evidence, and why this role.

COPY-READY: 60-SECOND ANSWER

I am a [role] based in [city]. For the last [duration] I have [the work] — most recently [specific example], which [result with a number]. I work in [tools], I am used to written briefs, and I can cover [overlap] with your team. The reason I applied for this role specifically is [one true, specific reason from their advert].

Type 2 — Behavioural: "tell me about a time when..."

You will be asked about a deadline you nearly missed, a mistake you made, a disagreement with a colleague, and a time you had to learn something fast. Prepare four stories, and reuse them.

STAR EXAMPLE — A DEADLINE THAT NEARLY SLIPPED (FICTIONAL)

Situation: I handled customer messages for a family retail business in a regional city. In the week before a national holiday, message volume roughly doubled and I was also covering the shop counter.

Task: Every message still had to be answered the same day, because customers were ordering stock that would not arrive in time otherwise.

Action: I wrote five short reply templates for the questions that made up most of the volume, put them in a document I could paste from, and sent the owner a message on the second morning saying I would not clear the backlog without help — with a specific ask, two hours a day from a colleague.

Result: Every message was answered within a day, the shop took 60 pre-orders that week, and the colleague kept using the templates after the holiday. The templates were still in use when I left.

STAR EXAMPLE — A MISTAKE YOU MADE (FICTIONAL)

Situation: While encoding records into a register at an office, I entered a batch of dates in the wrong format.

Task: Sixty rows were affected and another colleague was about to build a report from them.

Action: I told my supervisor the same afternoon, before the report was built, and spent the next morning re-checking the whole batch against the paper files. I then added a one-line note to the top of the sheet describing the date format so nobody could repeat it.

Result: The report went out a day late but correct. My supervisor's comment was that she would rather hear it early than find it late, and I was given the next batch to check as well.

WHY THE MISTAKE STORY WINS INTERVIEWS

Remote managers are not screening for people who have never failed. They are screening for people who tell them about it early. The shape — found it, said it, fixed it, stopped it recurring — is the exact shape they want on their team.

Type 3 — Practical, role-specific

You will be given a small scenario from the job: an angry customer, a messy spreadsheet, a vague brief, a broken page. There is no trick. They want to hear your process out loud.

— **Say what you would check first.** "First I would confirm what the customer actually wants — a refund, a replacement, or an explanation."

— **Say what you would not do.** "I would not promise a refund before checking the policy, because that creates a second problem."

— **Say who you would tell.** "If it looked like a product fault rather than a one-off, I would flag it to whoever owns the product."

— **Ask one clarifying question.** Asking a good question under pressure is a positive signal, not a weakness.

Type 4 — Logistics

Time zone, availability, internet, payment and country. Answer these plainly and without apology. Section 6.4 covers the connection question; Section 6.6 covers money.

6.4 Talking about your connection without sounding like a risk

You will be asked some version of "how reliable is your internet?" Do not say "it is fine". Do not over-explain. Give them a system.

COPY-READY: THE CONNECTION ANSWER

I have a main connection with [average speed] and a second SIM on a different network, and my phone hotspot as a third option. For anything with a fixed time I join two minutes early and test the link half an hour before. If video becomes unstable I switch to audio, which uses very little data, and I follow up in writing. If a call drops I message within ten minutes with a summary of what I missed and what I understood. I have worked this way for [duration] and it has not cost me a deadline.

STATE A FACT, THEN A SYSTEM

The sentence that damages you is "the internet here is bad sometimes." The sentence that helps you is "video can be unstable between 16:00 and 24:00, so I schedule my live calls earlier when I can, and I keep a second network for anything fixed." The first is a risk. The second is a plan.

6.5 The technical test

Most remote roles include a test task. It is your best opportunity in the whole process, because it is the only part you can do on your own time with your own tools.

1. **Read the brief twice and write down what you were asked for.** Then send one short message asking any question you genuinely cannot answer from the brief. This signals care, not confusion.
2. **Agree the deadline, and agree whether it is paid.** A short unpaid test is common and reasonable. An unpaid test that takes a full working week is not a test; it is free labour. It is fine to say so politely: "I can do a two-hour version unpaid, or the full version as a paid task."
3. **Time-box it and write down your assumptions.** Deliver exactly what was asked, plus a short note listing what you assumed and what you would do with more time. Never silently expand the scope.
4. **Make it quick to review.** One folder, a clear file name, a short PDF or a README explaining the work in plain language. If it is code, include how to run it. If it is a document, include a one-paragraph summary at the top.
5. **Submit before the deadline, not at it.** Twelve hours early is remembered. Five minutes late is remembered differently.

NEVER HAND OVER REAL WORK FOR FREE

If a "test" turns out to be a live task the company will use commercially, and the scope keeps expanding, stop and say so. Ask for a paid task, and if they refuse, withdraw. Section 09 and the anti-scam section cover the boundary between a normal test and free labour.

6.6 Salary questions and how to answer them

Money questions arrive near the end, and applicants lose offers here more often than anywhere else — usually by naming a number too early or too low.

EXPLAIN Whoever names a number first sets the ceiling. Your aim is to get their range before you give yours, without being evasive or difficult.

Interviewer: "What are your salary expectations?" You: "I would rather make sure the role is right first. Could you tell me the range budgeted for this position? Then I can tell you honestly whether it works at my level of experience." That is a complete, polite answer, and it works most of the time.

Before the interview, write down three numbers: the figure below which you would decline, the figure you think is fair, and the figure you would ask for if they pushed you to name one first. Research them from the employer's own posting and from people doing the same role in communities, as Section 02 describes.

You can say your number out loud in one calm sentence, with the currency and the period named. "I am looking for USD 700 a month on a part-time contract of 25 hours a week, and I am open to discussing the structure." If you stumble over the number, you have not practised it enough.

— **Always name the currency and the period.** "700" is meaningless. "USD 700 per month" is not. Where relevant, add the USD equivalent at the current rate so nobody is guessing — but lead with the currency they pay in.

— **If they say your number is above budget,** do not immediately drop it. Ask what the budget is, then decide whether to reduce scope rather than rate: fewer hours, a narrower set of tasks, a defined probation period.

— **If they offer below your floor,** say so plainly and once: "That is below what I can work for. If the budget is fixed, I understand, and I would rather say that now than in month two." Then let them decide.

— **Never quote a monthly figure and then discover it was weekly.** Confirm the period, the currency, the payment schedule and who pays the transfer fee. Those four questions belong in the interview, not after the offer.

> **ASK ABOUT THE PAYMENT ROUTE WHILE YOU ARE STILL INTERESTING**
>
> One extra sentence protects you:
>
> "How do you usually pay contractors outside your country, and who covers the transfer fee?"
>
> Asked at interview, this is a professional question. Asked after an offer, it can turn into a negotiation you were not expecting. Section 09 explains what the honest answers look like.

6.7 Questions you should ask

Ask three or four. Their answers tell you whether the job is real and whether you would survive it.

— What does a normal week look like in this role, and which hours are fixed?

— How do you prefer to communicate — written updates, a daily call, a weekly meeting?

— What would "going well" look like at the end of the first month?

— Who would I work with most closely, and how do they give feedback?

— How is the work tracked — a task board, tickets, a timesheet?

— Is the role a contract or employment, and is there a trial period?
— How do you pay contractors in other countries, and who covers the transfer fee?
— What happened to the last person in this role, if there was one?
— What is the next step in your process, and when should I expect to hear?

6.8 Pre-interview checklist

- [ ] Interview time confirmed in both time zones, written down.
- [ ] Calendar reminder set for 24 hours before and 40 minutes before.
- [ ] Meeting link tested the day before.
- [ ] Camera, microphone and light tested with another person.
- [ ] Room booked, door that closes, wall behind you.
- [ ] Laptop and phone charged above 80%, charger plugged in.
- [ ] Power bank charged and within reach.
- [ ] Second SIM topped up and hotspot tested.
- [ ] Phone number sent to the interviewer in advance.
- [ ] Data balance checked, with enough for a video call plus a margin.
- [ ] CV, the original posting and your three STAR stories printed or written on paper.
- [ ] Three questions chosen from 6.7.
- [ ] Water within reach, and nothing that rustles.
- [ ] Household told the time and asked to keep the room quiet and the door shut.
- [ ] Backup plan written on one piece of paper: network order, phone number, who to message.

6.9 Copy-ready messages after the interview

COPY-READY: "MY CONNECTION DROPPED" MESSAGE

Subject: Connection dropped — **[role]** interview, **[date]**

Hello **[name]**,

My connection dropped at **[time]** and I could not rejoin. I am sorry for the interruption — it was my side, not yours.

Here is what I understood before the call cut, and my answers to the parts I missed:

1. **[The last question you heard, and your answer.]**
2. **[Anything the interviewer asked that you had not yet answered.]**
3. **[Your question, if you had one left.]**

I am available to continue by phone on **[number]** at any time that suits you, including a voice-only call, which uses very little data on my side. I can also continue in writing if that is easier.

Thank you for your patience.
[Your name]

COPY-READY: THANK-YOU NOTE, SAME DAY

Subject: Thank you — [role]

Hello [name],

Thank you for the conversation today. I enjoyed hearing about [one specific thing they said].

One thing I did not say clearly: [one short, relevant point you wish you had made, in two sentences].

I am available [hours] hours a week with a [number]-hour overlap from [time] your city time. If a short test task would help you decide, I can start this week.

I look forward to hearing about the next step.
[Your name]

SEND IT WITHIN FOUR HOURS

Same day, while the conversation is still the most recent thing in their inbox. Two short paragraphs. No repetition of your CV, no new attachments unless they asked, and no second follow-up after this one.

07

SECTION SEVEN

Remote Work Etiquette and Communication

Written English that reads professionally without sounding stiff, agreed response times, how to write a status update that removes work from your manager, how to raise a problem before it becomes a crisis, asynchronous habits, meeting etiquette across cultures, how to say you do not understand without losing credibility, honest time tracking, and the confidentiality rules that protect you — with five copy-ready templates.

01 Written English that does not sound stiff

02 Response times you agree and keep

03 The status update

04 Raising a problem early

05 Asynchronous habits

06 Meeting etiquette across cultures

07 Saying "I do not understand"

08 Time tracking and timesheets

09 Confidentiality basics

10 Five copy-ready templates

You will be judged on your writing more than on anything else, because most of your work is invisible and your messages are the only evidence of it. This section is the difference between being trusted and being managed.

7.1 Written English that does not sound stiff

Two failure modes. Some applicants write the way they were taught to write essays: long sentences, formal vocabulary, apologies and padding. Others write the way they text. Both read badly to a manager abroad. The target is plain, direct, slightly warm, and short.

RULE	WEAK	BETTER
Lead with the answer	"I wanted to reach out regarding the matter we discussed concerning the report..."	"The report is finished. It is attached. One thing needs your decision."
One topic per message	A single paragraph covering the report, a payment question and next week's holiday.	Three short messages, or one message with three numbered points.
Name the action and the date	"I will try to get this done soon."	"I will send the first draft on Thursday before 15:00 your time."
Avoid idioms and slang	"I will touch base offline and circle back."	"I will send you a short update tomorrow."
Be careful with humour and sarcasm	A joke that depends on tone of voice.	Warm and plain. Tone does not survive text across cultures.
Do not over-apologise	"So sorry to bother you, I know you are very busy, apologies again..."	"Quick question — no rush."
Avoid "ASAP" and "urgent"	"Please reply ASAP."	"Could you reply by Wednesday? I am blocked after that."

THE FOUR-LINE TEST

Before you send anything longer than a few lines, ask: **if the reader only read the first line, would they know what I want?** If not, rewrite the first line until they would.

7.2 Response times you agree and keep

Do not guess what your employer expects. Agree it in writing in the first week, then keep it. The sentence takes thirty seconds and prevents months of silent friction.

COPY-READY: AGREEING YOUR RESPONSE WINDOW

So we are aligned: I will reply to messages within [window] during [your working hours] your city time, Monday to [day]. Anything after [time] my time I will pick up the next morning. If something is urgent outside those hours, call me on [number] rather than messaging — I would rather be woken than leave you waiting.

— **24 hours is a safe default** for most roles. Four hours is normal for support roles with live customers.

— **Acknowledge, even when you cannot answer.** "Got it — I will have an answer by tomorrow afternoon" is a complete reply.

— **Silence is the only real failure.** Managers forgive a slow answer. They do not forgive not knowing whether you saw the message.
— **Weekends and holidays:** say at the start what your weekend looks like. If you do not work Sundays, say so in week one rather than disappointing someone in week six.

7.3 The status update

A good status update removes work from the reader. It answers four questions in a fixed order, every time, so the reader can scan it in eight seconds.

1. **Done**
   What is finished, in outputs rather than effort. "Twelve support replies drafted and saved" rather than "worked on support replies".
2. **Next**
   What you will do next, and by when. One or two items, with a date.
3. **Blocked**
   Anything stuck, and what specifically is blocking it. Name the person or the missing thing. "Blocked: waiting for the brand files from `[name]`, needed by Tuesday."
4. **Need**
   The one decision or piece of information you need from them, phrased as a question with a deadline. Never leave this line empty if you are blocked; an unasked question is your fault, not theirs.

> **EFFORT IS NOT OUTPUT**
>
> "I worked on it all day" tells the reader nothing and quietly signals that you measure yourself by hours. Report what now exists that did not exist yesterday.

7.4 Raising a problem early

The moment you know something will be late, the deadline is already at risk — and every day you wait makes it worse. Early bad news is a professional skill. Late bad news is a performance issue.

EXPLAIN Use five lines, in this order: what happened, what it affects, what you have already done, what you need, and the new date you are committing to. Never send a problem without a proposed date.

"The power was out in my area from 14:00 to 19:00 and I lost three hours on the report. That means Thursday's draft would slip to Friday morning. I have the outline done and I am working from an offline copy, so nothing is lost. I need nothing from you. I will send the draft Friday by 12:00 your time." Five lines, no drama, no excuse-making, a new commitment.

Write your own version of those five lines now, with your real constraints — power, connection, family responsibility. Have it ready as a template in your notes so you are not composing it while stressed.

Your message contains a date and a specific ask, or an explicit statement that you need nothing. If it contains neither, it is a complaint, not an update.

7.5 Asynchronous habits

Async work means the other person reads your message hours after you wrote it, possibly in a different mood, possibly with six other things open. Write for that reader.

— **Put the ask in the first line.** Then the context. Nobody reads to the end to discover what you want.

— **Number your questions.** "Two questions: 1... 2..." gets two answers. A paragraph with two questions buried in it gets one.

— **Give the reader everything they need in one message.** Links, file names, dates, names. If they have to ask a follow-up in order to understand your question, you have cost them time.

— **Write decisions down.** If a decision was made on a call, post a two-line summary in the written channel: "Agreed on the call: we ship the short version first, full version in two weeks." This is how remote teams avoid repeating arguments.

— **Do not expect instant replies, and do not send "any update?"** after two hours. Check the agreed window in 7.2.

— **Respect their night.** Schedule messages to arrive in their working hours where the tool allows it. A 02:00 notification reads as pressure even when you did not mean it.

7.6 Meeting etiquette across cultures

Meeting norms differ. North American teams tend to be informal, direct, and quick to interrupt with questions. Northern European teams are quieter and more structured. Gulf and Asian teams often value a longer opening and more formality. None of this is a rule about individuals, and you will meet people who break every pattern. What follows is safe almost everywhere.

— **Join two minutes early.** Have your camera tested and your microphone muted if there is background noise.

— **Camera on where the connection allows.** If video is unstable, say so at the start and turn it off rather than freezing repeatedly. "I am switching to audio to keep the call steady" is respected; a stuttering picture is not.

— **Say your name when you speak first.** "This is Hanna — I think the second option is cheaper." Remote calls blur voices, and it saves the group time.

— **Do not multitask.** People can hear typing and see your eyes move. If you must miss part of a call, say so in advance.

— **Take notes on paper and send a short summary afterwards** if you were the one presenting or if decisions were made.

— **Accept silence.** In some cultures a pause before answering is respectful; in others it reads as hesitation. When in doubt, add one sentence of reasoning rather than filling the gap with "yes, yes".

— **No eating, and nothing that rustles.** This is not about strictness; it is about how much noise reaches their headphones.

> **THE CHEAPEST REPUTATION YOU CAN BUILD**
>
> Join on time, come with one useful sentence prepared, and send a two-line summary within an hour. Teams remember who does this far longer than they remember who spoke most.

7.7 Saying "I do not understand" without losing credibility

Pretending to understand is the most expensive habit in remote work, because the misunderstanding surfaces later, at the deadline, when fixing it is no longer cheap. Say it early and specifically.

COPY-READY: THREE WAYS TO SAY YOU DO NOT UNDERSTAND

When the brief is unclear: "I want to make sure I build the right thing. My understanding is [your restatement]. Is that correct, or did you mean [the alternative you are unsure about]?"

When a word or instruction is unfamiliar: "I have not come across [term] before. Could you point me to an example of what good looks like? I would rather ask now than deliver the wrong thing."

On a call, when you miss something: "Sorry — the audio cut for a second. Could you repeat the last part? I got [what you did hear] but missed the rest."

Notice the pattern: every version includes what you *did* understand. That is what separates a clarifying question from someone who was not listening.

7.8 Time tracking and timesheets

Many remote contracts are paid by the hour and tracked with software that takes screenshots or records activity. Other contracts are paid for output and need no tracking at all. Either way, honesty is the only sustainable approach, and it is also the one that survives an audit or a dispute.

— **Track as you go, not from memory on Friday.** Reconstructing a week produces either an inflated number or a number you cannot defend.

— **Log the work, not the mood.** "Drafted section 3 of the report, 90 minutes" is a record. "Worked on project, 8 hours" is not.

— **Never bill for time you were not working.** If you take a two-hour break, subtract it. If a task took less time than expected, say so — it builds the trust that gets you a retainer.

— **Submit before the deadline.** Late timesheets delay your own payment, and in some companies they delay everyone's payroll run.

— **Keep your own copy.** Your timesheet is the evidence for your invoice, and you may need it months later.

THE HABIT THAT TURNS A CONTRACT INTO A JOB

At the end of every month, send one short line summarising what you delivered and what it produced. Nobody asks for this. It is the single most effective thing a contractor can do, because it answers the question your employer will be asked at budget time: what is this person actually giving us?

7.9 Confidentiality basics

You will handle other people's customer lists, prices, unreleased plans and personal data. Treating that carefully is not optional, and it takes little effort to get right.

— **Do not share client data outside the tools the client gave you.** Not into a personal spreadsheet, not into a chat with a friend, not into a free AI tool you have not been told to use. If you are unsure whether a tool is approved, ask.

— **Do not post screenshots of your work.** Even a dashboard can contain names, revenue figures or an unreleased product. If you want to show your work, ask permission and anonymise it first.
— **Do not keep working copies after a contract ends.** Delete local copies of client files when the engagement finishes, unless you have written permission to keep them for a portfolio.
— **Use your own device, and lock it.** A password or PIN on the phone and laptop, and separate work accounts rather than one shared login for everything.
— **Never share a one-time code or a password** with anyone, including someone claiming to be from the company's IT team. That request is a scam in every case — the anti-scam section at the end of this book documents the account-takeover pattern that has been reported where you liven press.
— **If you are unsure whether something is confidential, assume it is** and ask before sharing.

7.10 Five copy-ready templates

TEMPLATE 1 — DAILY STANDUP UPDATE

Yesterday: [what now exists that did not exist before].

Today: [what you will finish, and by when].

Blocked: [nothing / what is stuck and who or what it depends on].

Need from you: [one specific answer, or "nothing today"].

TEMPLATE 2 — WEEKLY STATUS REPORT

Week of [date] **—** [your name]**,** [role]

Delivered:

1. [Output, with a number].
2. [Output, with a number].
3. [Output, with a number].

Numbers: [the two or three figures this role is measured on, per Section 02].

Next week: [two or three items with dates].

Risks: [anything that could slip, with the reason and your plan].

Decisions I need: [question 1, question 2, or "none this week"].

TEMPLATE 3 — DELAY WARNING

Subject: [Task] — revised date [new date]

Hello [name],

What happened: [one sentence, factual, no excuses].

What it affects: [the specific deliverable and who is waiting on it].

What I have done: [the action you already took].

New date I am committing to: [date and time, in their time zone].

What I need from you: [one specific thing, or "nothing"].

I am sorry for the change and I will send an update [when] even if there is nothing new to report.
[Your name]

TEMPLATE 4 — CLARIFICATION REQUEST

Hello [name],

Before I start on [task], I want to check two things so I do not build the wrong version.

1. My understanding is [your restatement]. Is that right?

2. For [the ambiguous part], should I [option A] or [option B]?

I will begin with [the part that is not affected] while I wait, so nothing is held up. If I do not hear back by [date] I will assume [the default you choose] and note it in the handover.

[Your name]

TEMPLATE 5 — END-OF-PROJECT HANDOVER NOTE

Handover — [project or role], [your name], [date]

What this covers: [one sentence].

Current state: [what is finished, what is in progress, what was never started].

Where everything lives: [folders, links, file names, account names — never passwords in an email].

How to do the routine tasks: [numbered steps for the three tasks someone else will now do].

Open issues: [each one with the status, the owner and the next step].

Things I would do next if I were staying: [two or three honest suggestions].

People to ask: [names and what each one knows].

I am available for questions until [date] at [email]. After that, this note is the record.
[Your name]

THE HANDOVER NOTE IS A JOB APPLICATION

Write it as if the reader is deciding whether to hire you again. Contract work is a small world, and a clean handover is how a client becomes a reference, a repeat engagement or a full-time offer — the route described in Section 10.

08

SECTION EIGHT

Time Zones, Schedule and Reliability

How to calculate the overlap between your city and a client anywhere in the world, which overlaps suit which roles, how to build a working day around family responsibilities and power cuts, a four-part personal reliability system you can describe to an employer, and how to communicate a planned absence so that it costs you nothing.

01 your city time, and how to calculate overlap

02 The worked time-zone table

03 Which overlaps suit which roles

04 Building a schedule that survives real life

05 The personal reliability system

06 Communicating a planned absence

Time zones are the one part of remote work that is pure arithmetic. There is no negotiation and no luck. Learn the arithmetic once and you will stop losing roles you could have done comfortably.

8.1 your city time, and how to calculate overlap

your country runs on a single time zone, **UTC+3**, all year, with no daylight saving. That stability is an advantage: your working hours never shift, while your employer's do. A team in London or New York will move by an hour twice a year and you will not.

your country also keeps its own clock, where the day starts at 06:00 and is counted in twelve-hour halves. When you talk to an employer abroad, always use the international clock and write the time zone next to it. Write **15:00 (UTC+3)**, never "9 o'clock in the afternoon". Ambiguity about a meeting time is one of the cheapest ways to look unreliable.

1. **Find the employer's current offset from UTC**
   Not the offset in general — the offset on the date you are scheduling. Daylight saving changes it twice a year in Europe, North America and Australia.
2. **Subtract 3 from their offset**
   The gap between you and them is (their offset) minus (+3). If their offset is 0, they are 3 hours behind you. If their offset is +5:30, they are 2 hours 30 minutes ahead of you.
3. **Convert their working day into yours**
   Take their 09:00 to 17:00 and apply the gap. That converted block is the window you are being asked to cover, and it is the only number that matters in the negotiation.
4. **Write the overlap down and send it**
   "I can cover 15:00 to 19:00 your city time, which is your 12:00 to 16:00." One sentence, and the employer stops worrying about it.

> **VERIFY OFFSETS ON THE DAY YOU SCHEDULE**
>
> Time-zone offsets change with daylight saving, and a few countries change their rules at short notice. The table below is a planning guide, not a calendar. Confirm the current offset before you commit to a fixed meeting time.

8.2 The worked time-zone table

The table shows what a normal **09:00 to 17:00** working day abroad looks like in your city. The overlap column assumes you can work from 09:00 to 20:00 your time, which is a long but realistic remote day.

EMPLOYER LOCATION	THEIR OFFSET (WINTER / SUMMER)	THEIR 09:00 – 17:00 IN ADDIS	OVERLAP WITH A 09:00 – 20:00 ADDIS DAY
Dubai, United Arab Emirates	UTC+4 all year	08:00 – 16:00	8 hours. The easiest overlap available
Nairobi, Kenya	UTC+3 all year	09:00 – 17:00	8 hours. Identical clock, no adjustment at all

EMPLOYER LOCATION	THEIR OFFSET (WINTER / SUMMER)	THEIR 09:00 – 17:00 IN ADDIS	OVERLAP WITH A 09:00 – 20:00 ADDIS DAY
London, United Kingdom	UTC+0 / UTC+1	12:00 – 20:00 (winter) · 11:00 – 19:00 (summer)	8 hours in winter, 8 in summer. Comfortable

EMPLOYER LOCATION	THEIR OFFSET (WINTER / SUMMER)	THEIR 09:00 – 17:00 IN ADDIS	OVERLAP WITH A 09:00 – 20:00 ADDIS DAY
Berlin, Paris, Madrid	UTC+1 / UTC+2	11:00 – 19:00 (winter) · 10:00 – 18:00 (summer)	8 hours. Good for full-time roles
Bengaluru, India	UTC+5:30 all year	06:30 – 14:30	5.5 hours, but early. Suits support and data roles

EMPLOYER LOCATION	THEIR OFFSET (WINTER / SUMMER)	THEIR 09:00 – 17:00 IN ADDIS	OVERLAP WITH A 09:00 – 20:00 ADDIS DAY
Singapore	UTC+8 all year	04:00 – 12:00	3 hours, all before noon. Suits asynchronous roles only
New York, United States	UTC−5 / UTC−4	17:00 – 01:00 (winter) · 16:00 – 00:00 (summer)	3 hours in the evening. Demanding but possible
Chicago, United States	UTC−6 / UTC−5	18:00 – 02:00 (winter) · 17:00 – 01:00 (summer)	2 hours in the evening
San Francisco, United States	UTC−8 / UTC−7	20:00 – 04:00 (winter) · 19:00 – 03:00 (summer)	0 to 1 hour. Treat as an asynchronous role or a night shift
Sydney, Australia	UTC+10 / UTC+11	02:00 – 10:00 (their summer) · 01:00 – 09:00 (their winter)	1 hour at the start of your day

Offsets are shown for planning only and change with daylight saving. Convert again on the day you schedule anything. your city is UTC+3 with no daylight saving.

> **THE THREE LINES THAT MAKE THIS USEFUL**
>
> A Dubai or Nairobi employer overlaps your whole working day. A European employer overlaps your afternoon and evening. A US West Coast employer overlaps your night, and you should only accept that if the role is genuinely asynchronous or you have decided to work nights for a defined period.

8.3 Which overlaps suit which roles

ROLE	OVERLAP YOU NEED	BEST EMPLOYER REGIONS FOR YOU
Data-entry assistant	1 hour, mostly asynchronous	Anywhere. This is the most time-zone-tolerant role on the list
Content writer	1 to 2 hours, plus written feedback	Anywhere with a written culture. Europe and North America both work
Researcher	2 hours	Europe, the Gulf, East Africa

ROLE	OVERLAP YOU NEED	BEST EMPLOYER REGIONS FOR YOU
Designer	3 hours, for feedback rounds	Europe, the Gulf. Avoid US West Coast unless the process is written

ROLE	OVERLAP YOU NEED	BEST EMPLOYER REGIONS FOR YOU
Developer	3 to 4 hours for standups and review	Europe, the Gulf, India. US East Coast at a stretch

ROLE	OVERLAP YOU NEED	BEST EMPLOYER REGIONS FOR YOU
Customer support agent	4 or more, often fixed shifts	Europe, the Gulf, East Africa, India. Ask whether shifts rotate
Virtual assistant	4 or more, responsive during their day	Europe and the Gulf. A US West Coast assistant role means working their morning as your evening
Appointment setter	4 or more, live calling hours	Europe and the Gulf, where calling hours fall in your afternoon and evening
Sales development assistant	3 to 4 hours	Europe and the Gulf. Written sequences travel better than calls
Social-media assistant	2 to 3 hours	Anywhere, if scheduling is used rather than live posting

SAY THE NUMBER BEFORE THEY ASK

Put your overlap window in the CV summary, the LinkedIn About section and the first paragraph of your application. Employers screen out candidates they assume cannot overlap. Removing the assumption is free.

8.4 Building a schedule that survives real life

A remote schedule that ignores your household, your power supply and your connection will fail in week three. Build the one you can actually keep.

01 Work with the grid, not against it

Published worst-case freelancer speeds fall as low as 98 Kb/s between 16:00 and 24:00. Put your heaviest uploads, video calls and file transfers before 16:00 where you can, and keep the evening for reading, writing and messages.

02 Protect one fixed block

Choose a two-to-four-hour window you will always be online, and tell your employer what it is. Everything else can move. A promise you keep beats a longer promise you break.

03 Plan around the household

If you share a room, agree the hours in advance with the people you live with and put them on the wall. Cooking, water collection, childcare and school runs are fixed points; schedule the work around them rather than pretending they will move.

04 Take a real day off

Pick one day a week with no work and tell your employer at the start. Burnout in remote work comes from the absence of a boundary, not from the volume of work, and it is the most common reason people quietly stop delivering.

8.5 The personal reliability system

This is what you describe when an interviewer asks how you handle outages. Four parts, all cheap, all prepared before you need them.

1. **A charged power bank, always**
   One power bank that can charge your phone at least twice, kept charged, and a second smaller one if you can. Charge both every time the power comes on, without thinking about it. Write the charging into your weekly routine or it will be empty when you need it.

2. **Offline copies of everything you need**
   Download the documents, briefs, files and reference material you need for the current task onto your device. Set documents to be available offline. If the connection dies for four hours, you should still be able to work, and that fact alone changes how an employer sees you.

3. **A written backup plan on one page**
   Network order, phone number, who to message, what to say. Written down, on paper, next to your desk. Under pressure you will not remember the plan you made last month.

4. **The 15-minute-early habit**
   For anything with a fixed time, be ready fifteen minutes early: device charged, link tested, notes out, room quiet. It costs nothing and it is the single behaviour that most reliably makes a remote manager relax.

COPY-READY: ONE-PAGE BACKUP PLAN YOU CAN HAND TO AN EMPLOYER

My working setup — [your name], [city], **your country (UTC+3)**

Primary connection: [network and typical speed]. Tested at [time of day].

Backup 1: second SIM, different network, [network].
Backup 2: phone hotspot for the laptop.
Backup 3: [neighbour or nearby connection, arranged in advance].
Backup 4: voice call only, which works at very low data speeds.

If I drop out of a call: I rejoin once, then switch to audio, then call [number] within one minute. If none of that works I email a written summary within ten minutes.

Power: two charged power banks; laptop and phone charged to 100% before any fixed meeting.

Offline working: all current files are available offline, so an outage does not stop the work.

My fixed online hours: [start] to [end] your city time, Monday to [day]. Outside those hours I answer by [next morning / within X hours].

8.6 Communicating a planned absence

You will need days off. Weddings, funerals, exams, family obligations, medical appointments and religious holidays are not optional where you live, and no reasonable employer expects you to pretend otherwise. What they expect is notice.

— **Tell them as early as you know.** Two weeks is generous, one week is normal, two days is acceptable for a real emergency.

— **State the dates in their time zone, and what you will do about the work.** Not only "I will be away" — say who covers it, or what you will deliver before you go.

— **Say whether you will be reachable.** "I will not be available at all on these two days" is more useful than silence, and it is respected.

— **Hand over before you go.** Use the handover note in Section 07 for anything that continues while you are away.

— **Never disappear without telling anyone.** A planned absence costs you nothing. An unexplained one costs you the contract.

COPY-READY: PLANNED ABSENCE NOTICE

Subject: Planned absence [dates]

Hello [name],

I will be unavailable from [date and time in their time zone] to [date and time] for [a family commitment / a public holiday / a medical appointment].

Before I go I will finish [the specific deliverables] and send a short handover note covering anything in progress. [Name or "nobody"] can cover [the routine part] while I am away.

I will check messages [once a day in the evening / not at all]. If something genuinely cannot wait, call [number] and I will answer if I can.

I am back on [date] and will send an update that morning.
[Your name]

THE ONE THING THAT KEEPS A CONTRACT ALIVE

Communicate the plan before the absence, not after it. Almost every employer will approve almost any reasonable absence. Almost none will forgive finding out from a missed deadline.

09

SECTION NINE

Getting Paid by a Foreign Employer

The honest, verified chapter: how foreign earnings reach a resident of a country with limited payment access through your regulator-licensed remittance corridor, what is not verified about international payment platforms, the legitimate upgrade path from TIN to business licence to registered service exporter, the hard prohibitions that end careers, and the practical side — agreeing a schedule, invoicing, chasing a late payment and keeping a record for tax.

01 The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

02 Local clients versus international clients

03 The legitimate routes, in order

04 What never to do

05 Tax and registration, honestly

This is the section that decides whether a remote job is real for you. Everything else in this book is a skill. This is a fact about how money moves, and getting it wrong wastes months. Read it twice, and verify anything that matters before you rely on it.

Getting Paid by a Foreign Employer

This is the chapter that decides whether the rest of the book turns into money. It is also the chapter most online advice gets wrong, because most online advice assumes you live in a country with a full set of payment rails. If you do, the short version is at the end of this section. If you do not, the rest of this section is for you.

> **THE ONE RULE THAT PREVENTS ALMOST EVERY PROBLEM**
>
> **Agree the payment route with the client before you agree the price.** Not after the work is done, not in the invoice, not when they ask for your bank details. Before.
>
> A client who cannot pay you the way you need is not a client. They are a conversation. Finding that out on delivery day is the most expensive lesson in this book, and it is entirely avoidable with one question asked early.

How money actually crosses a border

When a client in another country pays you, the money does not travel directly. It moves through a chain, and every link in that chain is a place where it can stop. Knowing the chain tells you which question to ask.

1. **The client pays something**
   A card, a PayPal balance, a bank transfer, a mobile wallet, a local payment method. What they can use depends on *their* country, not yours.

2. **A processor authorises it**
   Stripe, PayPal, Adyen, a regional gateway. This is where most cross-border problems originate, because processors operate country by country.

3. **A platform holds it**
   If you sell through a marketplace or course platform, they hold the money and pay you later, on their schedule, at their minimum.

4. **It is paid out to you**
   A bank deposit in your local currency, a PayPal transfer, or a wallet credit. **This is the link that fails most often**, and it is the one nobody checks before they start.

EXPLAIN Buyer-side and seller-side are independent. What your client can use to pay has nothing to do with what you can receive. A platform can be perfectly good for your buyers and completely useless for paying you.

SHOW *Example — fictional.* A writer in Nairobi sells a $25 template pack. Buyers pay by card without difficulty. The platform's payout page then shows one option: PayPal. The writer's PayPal account can send but cannot receive. Fourteen sales, $350, stuck behind a payout route that was never tested.

DO Before you build anything, open the payout settings of every platform you are considering and write down, in one sentence, exactly how money would reach your bank account.

CHECK Can you name the rail, the currency, the minimum payout and the delay? If any of those four is a guess, you have not finished checking.

The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

Do this once per platform. It takes about twenty minutes and it prevents weeks of wasted work.

QUESTION	WHERE TO LOOK	WHAT A USABLE ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
1. Does this platform pay out to my country?	The platform's own payout-settings page or help article — never a blog post, never a YouTube video	Your country named on the platform's own list, with the payout currency
2. Through which rail?	The same page	A named method: local bank deposit, PayPal, Payoneer, wallet. "Contact support" is not an answer
3. What is the minimum and the delay?	The payout help article	A number and a schedule, so you can plan cash flow
4. What does it cost in total?	The pricing page *and* the fees help article — they often disagree	Platform fee plus processing fee, added together, expressed as a percentage of a typical sale

TWO RULES THAT WILL SAVE YOU MONEY

Read the payout page, not the signup page. Almost every platform lets you sign up from almost anywhere. That tells you nothing. The gate is payout.

Check whether two platforms share a rail. If two services both pay through the same underlying processor, they are not backups of each other. When that one rail has a problem, both stop at once. Verify the underlying rail, not just the brand on the front.

Local clients versus international clients

These are two different problems and they need two different answers. Do not let one delay the other.

	LOCAL CLIENTS	INTERNATIONAL CLIENTS
What works	Bank transfer, mobile wallet, cash, a local card gateway. Almost always available to an individual with no registered business.	A licensed remittance corridor, a platform that pays out to your country, or an employer's own payroll route.
Speed	Same day, often same hour	Days to weeks, depending on the platform's payout schedule
What can block it	Nothing much, if you have an account in your own name	Country eligibility, missing documents, a rail that does not reach you
Best first move	Start here. Local clients pay for your proof.	Test the payout route with a small real payment before you promise anything

THE TEST PAYMENT

Before you quote a single international client, run one small real transaction end to end: sell something cheap — a $5 template, a $10 review, a single small job — and take it all the way to money in your account.

This costs you one afternoon and one small fee. It converts every assumption in this chapter into a fact, and it is the single most useful hour in this entire book.

What to say to a client about payment

Clients are not suspicious of payment questions. They are suspicious of vague ones. Say the route plainly, in the first conversation, in writing.

COPY-READY: THE PAYMENT-ROUTING MESSAGE

Before we start, one practical thing so neither of us has a surprise at the end.

I am paid by **[route: bank transfer / a named platform / a licensed transfer service]**. The money arrives in **[currency]**, and I can start work as soon as the first payment shows on my side.

If you would rather use a different method, tell me now and I will check whether it works — I would rather spend five minutes on this today than a week on it later.

For **[amount]** the split is **[50]** % to start and **[50]** % on delivery.

COPY-READY: WHEN A PAYMENT IS LATE

Hello **[name]** — checking in on the **[amount]** for **[work]**, which I sent on **[date]**. It has not shown on my side yet.

Could you confirm the date it was sent and the reference number? If it has not gone out yet, no problem — just let me know when it will, and I will plan around that.

Pricing when the route costs money

Cross-border routes cost the sender or the receiver money. Decide who absorbs it before you quote, and put it in the price rather than discovering it later.

WORKED EXAMPLE — TARGET ARITHMETIC, NOT A FORECAST

```
Your price for the work: $100
Transfer or platform cost, if you absorb it: $5–$15
What actually reaches you: $85–$95
```

Two ways to handle it: quote a price that already includes the cost, or state plainly that transfer fees are the sender's. What you must not do is quote $100 and then argue about $12 after delivery.

NEVER DO THESE THINGS, WHATEVER ANYONE TELLS YOU

— **Never enter a false country, name or address** on a payment platform. It breaches the provider's terms, it usually fails identity verification anyway, and the consequence is a frozen balance and a closed account — with your customers refunded and your earnings gone.

— **Never use a relative's or friend's account abroad** to receive money that is yours. It is the same misrepresentation with extra steps, and it puts their account at risk too.

— **Never use a VPN to open a financial account** in a country you do not live in.

— **Never buy or rent a verified account.** The seller keeps access to it.

— **Never accept payment in a form your country restricts.** Several countries prohibit or restrict virtual-asset transactions; check your own before you accept anything unusual.

The published terms are unambiguous about this. Most platforms require you not to "create an account using a false identity or information, or on behalf of someone other than yourself", and prohibit misrepresenting your "identity, location or credentials". The stated remedy is suspension or termination, and where an underlying processor makes the final call it is often not appealable.

The legitimate routes, in the order worth trying

#	ROUTE	WHO IT SUITS	WHAT TO VERIFY FIRST
1	A platform that publishes your country on its own payout list, paying into a local bank account in local currency	Anyone selling digital products or courses	That the payout page offers *bank deposit*, not "PayPal only", for your country
2	A licensed money-transfer service (Western Union, MoneyGram, Remitly, WorldRemit and similar) for a one-off client payment	Freelancers and service sellers with a single client	That the receiving country and currency appear on the provider's own corridor list
3	An employer's own payroll or contractor route	Remote employees and long-term contractors	That the employer has paid a contractor in your country before — ask them directly
4	Registering as an exporter of services and receiving into a foreign-currency account	Anyone earning regularly from abroad	Your own country's rules. In several countries this unlocks full retention of foreign-currency earnings and an international card — ask a local accountant, do not guess
5	Trading through a properly registered company in the country where the payout account sits	Established sellers doing meaningful volume	Real incorporation, a real bank account there, real accounting, and any home-country approval required. Legitimate, but slow and expensive — not a shortcut

IF YOU ALREADY HAVE FULL PAYMENT RAILS

Then most of this chapter is not your constraint, and your fastest route is whatever your clients already use: Stripe, PayPal, a card gateway. Skim the four verification questions above anyway — the platform fee difference between two similar services is often several percentage points, and on a hundred sales a year that is real money.

Tax and registration, stated honestly

THIS IS NOT TAX ADVICE, AND THE RULES ARE LOCAL

Almost every country requires you to declare income you earn, and most require some form of tax registration once you are trading. What that means in practice — a tax number, a business registration, a turnover-tax threshold, a VAT threshold — differs enormously from country to country, and the thresholds change.

What to do: find your national tax authority's own website, look for the page on registering as a sole trader or self-employed person, and read the current threshold. If your earnings are small, you may be below every threshold. If they are not, register. A local accountant charges very little for one hour of advice, and that hour is worth more than any general guidance in a book written for the whole world.

Keep a simple record from your first sale: date, client, amount, currency, what it was for, and the fee deducted. That one sheet makes tax time trivial and makes you look professional if anyone ever asks.

IF YOU SELL THROUGH A MARKETPLACE, READ THIS

Large platforms are often the *merchant of record*, meaning they handle sales tax and VAT for the buyer and remit it themselves. That does not remove your obligation to declare the income you receive. It changes what you have to collect, not whether you have to report.

Some platforms also require a tax form before they will pay you at all — a W-9 if you are in the United States, a W-8 series form if you are not, or a local equivalent. If a form is required and not submitted, payouts are usually paused. Complete it early rather than after your first sale.

10

SECTION TEN

From Freelance to Remote, and the Two Plans

How a freelancer converts repeat clients into a salaried or retainer role, what to put in the pitch, how to ask for a contract instead of more gigs — then two complete plans: fourteen days to become remote-ready, and thirty days of applications, follow-ups and interviews, both laid out day by day with an objective, a task, an example, an output and a check.

01 From repeat client to contract

02 What to put in the pitch

03 How to ask for a contract, not more gigs

04 The 14-day remote-ready plan

05 The 30-day application plan

06 After day 30

Two plans, one purpose: to make you the applicant whose files already exist. The first fourteen days build every asset. The next thirty put them in front of employers, five applications a week, with follow-ups that stop at the right moment.

10.1 From repeat client to contract

The most reliable employer is a client who has already paid you three times. They know your work, they have already solved the payment question, and the risk question is answered. What is missing is a structure.

EXPLAIN The move is not from "no work" to "job". It is from **task, task, task** to **scope, then retainer, then contract**. Each step asks for a little more structure and a little less improvisation.

You have written four articles for one client over two months, each commissioned separately. You propose a monthly retainer: four articles a month, one topic call, two revision rounds, invoiced on the 1st. The client says yes because they already wanted the articles and now they do not have to commission each one.

List every client who has paid you twice or more. For each, write the retainer you would propose: the monthly scope, the price, and what you would stop doing. One page per client, on paper.

Your retainer proposal fits in one short paragraph and names a monthly figure, a scope and a delivery rhythm. If it needs a page of explanation, it is too complicated to be agreed over email.

10.2 What to put in the pitch

A pitch is not a request. It is an offer with a number in it. Five parts, in this order: what you have done for them, what you noticed, what you propose, what it costs, and what happens next.

COPY-READY: RETAINER PITCH TO AN EXISTING CLIENT

Subject: A simpler way to keep the `[work type]` coming

Hello `[name]`,

Over the last `[period]` I have delivered `[what, with numbers]`. Commissioning it piece by piece works, but it costs you a message and a decision every time.

I would like to propose a monthly arrangement: `[scope, e.g. four articles a month]`, one `[call or written brief]` at the start of the month, `[number]` revision rounds included, delivered `[rhythm]`. The rate would be `[amount and currency]` per month, invoiced on the `[day]`.

It gives you a predictable output and gives me enough notice to plan the work properly, which is the main reason the quality has been consistent.

Shall I send a one-page summary of the scope so you can review it? If you would rather continue as we are, that is completely fine — nothing changes.

`[Your name]`

ALWAYS LEAVE THE DOOR OPEN

Every pitch ends with a version of "if you would rather continue as we are, that is fine". It removes the pressure, and in practice it is what makes people say yes.

10.3 How to ask for a contract, not more gigs

After three or four months of a retainer that is going well, you can ask for the structure of employment: fixed hours, a title, a place in the team, and the stability that comes with it. Ask once, in writing, with evidence.

— **Time it after a good month.** Not during a quiet period, not after a mistake, not in the same message as an invoice query.

— **Lead with what they get, not what you want.** More availability, more predictability, someone who can join internal calls and own a recurring piece of the work.

— **Bring the evidence.** A one-page summary of everything you have delivered and what it produced. Most clients have never seen their own numbers assembled like this.

— **Name what you are asking for specifically.** "A part-time contract of 20 hours a week at `[rate]`, with `[responsibility]`" is answerable. "A more permanent arrangement" is not.

— **Give a decision date and accept a no.** "Could we decide by `[date]`? If it is not possible, I will keep going as we are and I am glad of the work."

> **SOME CLIENTS WILL NEVER CONVERT, AND THAT IS NORMAL**
>
> Some companies cannot hire outside their own country, some cannot take on contractors at all, and some prefer buying tasks. When you get a clear no, believe it once, and put your energy into the next three clients on your list. Keep the retainer running if it is working.

10.4 The 14-day remote-ready plan

About 90 minutes a day. By day 14 every asset this book describes will exist. Do not skip a day to read ahead — the plan is sequential, and each day uses the output of the one before it.

DAY 01 Choose one role and one backup

OBJECTIVE	Stop considering ten roles and commit to two.
TASK	Read the ten-role table in Section 02 and the self-assessment worksheet. Score yourself honestly, then choose a primary and a backup role.
EXAMPLE	Primary: customer support agent. Backup: data-entry assistant. Both suit someone with retail counter experience and no laptop of their own yet.
OUTPUT	Two role names written down, plus a one-line reason for each.
CHECK	☐ You can name one thing you have already done that resembles each role.

DAY 02 Build the evidence list

OBJECTIVE	Find the raw material for your CV before you try to write it.
TASK	List ten things you have done in three years that involved other people, a deadline or a finished document. For each, add a number if one exists.
EXAMPLE	"Answered customer messages for the family shop; roughly 30 a week; kept a written log for 14 months."
OUTPUT	A list of ten items, at least four with numbers.
CHECK	☐ Every item could be described to an interviewer without inventing anything.

DAY 03 Write the master CV

OBJECTIVE	Produce a one-page CV that a machine can read and a human can skim.
TASK	Use the annotated template in Section 03. Single column, no photo, one page. Write the summary line using the formula.
EXAMPLE	The fictional CV in Section 3.8 shows the finished shape at one page.
OUTPUT	Firstname-Lastname-CV.pdf, exported and opened on your phone.
CHECK	☐ One page on a phone, readable without zooming. ☐ Summary names the role, the evidence and the overlap window.

DAY 04 Rewrite every duty as an achievement

OBJECTIVE	Remove every "responsible for" from the CV and replace it with a result.
TASK	Apply the four rewrites in Section 3.4 to your own lines. Then translate your degree, any national service, any family business role and any volunteer work using the table in 3.3.
EXAMPLE	"Helped with social media" becomes "Ran the shop's Facebook and Telegram pages for 14 months and answered about 30 customer messages a week."
OUTPUT	CV version 2, with no duty-only bullets.
CHECK	☐ Every bullet has a number, a tool, a duration or a result. ☐ You could show evidence for every line if asked.

DAY 05 Rebuild the LinkedIn profile

OBJECTIVE	Be findable by a recruiter searching for your role, your tools and your time zone.
TASK	Fix the five fields in Section 4.1: photo, headline, About, location and open-to-work. Use the About template. Set your location to your real city.
EXAMPLE	Headline: "Customer Support Assistant | Help desk and chat | 4-hour overlap with Europe (UTC+3)".
OUTPUT	A complete LinkedIn profile with a public URL.
CHECK	☐ Location says your real city. ☐ At least three role keywords appear in the headline and About.

DAY 06 Email, signature and portfolio skeleton

OBJECTIVE	Set up the two links that appear on every application.
TASK	Create a work-only email address with two-step verification. Add the four-line signature from Section 4.2. Create the portfolio folder structure from 4.3 and share it view-only.
EXAMPLE	Folder: "Hanna Bekele — Work Samples", containing "00 — Start Here" and three empty sub-folders.
OUTPUT	Email signature in place; portfolio link tested while logged out.
CHECK	☐ The link opens on a phone in a private window. ☐ Two-step verification is on.

DAY 07 Sample project one

OBJECTIVE	Produce the first piece of proof for your primary role.
TASK	Invent a fictional business, write yourself a brief that matches a real posting you found, do the work, and label it with the standard sample label from 4.7.
EXAMPLE	A 15-template support reply pack for a fictional online store, covering refunds, late delivery and damaged goods.
OUTPUT	One finished deliverable, labelled, in the portfolio folder.
CHECK	☐ The word SAMPLE appears on the file. ☐ File size is small enough to open on mobile data.

DAY 08 Sample project two, harder

OBJECTIVE	Prove you can repeat the work under a tighter constraint.
TASK	Same role, different industry, deliberately harder: fewer hours, more data, or an awkward requirement. Time yourself.
EXAMPLE	The same reply pack rewritten for a fictional tour operator, with a stricter tone and a shorter response target.
OUTPUT	Second labelled sample, plus the time it took.
CHECK	☐ You can state how long it took, because employers ask.

DAY 09 Sample project three, with a revision round

OBJECTIVE	Show that you can take feedback, which is what remote managers worry about most.
TASK	Make a third piece, ask a friend or a community member to criticise it properly, then revise it and write one paragraph on what you changed and why.
EXAMPLE	"The reviewer said the refund template sounded defensive, so I rewrote the first line to lead with the action instead of the policy."
OUTPUT	Both versions plus the revision note, in the third sample folder.
CHECK	☐ Your revision note names the criticism and the specific change.

DAY 10 Ask for one real pro-bono piece

OBJECTIVE	Get one piece of real work with a real person attached to it.
TASK	Write to three organisations or small businesses you already know. Offer one specific piece of work, free, with a fixed scope and a deadline, and ask permission to describe it afterwards.
EXAMPLE	"I can write your volunteer sign-up page and a one-page FAQ, delivered by `[date]`. No charge. I would like to describe the work as a sample afterwards."
OUTPUT	Three sent asks, in writing, with a scope and a date.
CHECK	☐ Each message names exactly what you will deliver and by when. ☐ You asked for permission before starting.

DAY 11 Build the tracker and the target list

OBJECTIVE Have somewhere to put every application before you send one.

TASK Create the twelve-column tracker from Section 5.5 in a free spreadsheet app on your phone. Then list twenty companies that already hire remotely, with the real problem you noticed for each.

EXAMPLE Row: "2026-10-02 | [company] | Support Assistant | Direct | [link] | [name] | not stated | ask | UTC+1, 4h | Sent | 2026-10-06 | Help page last updated 2023."

OUTPUT Tracker open and saved on your phone; twenty companies listed with one problem each.

CHECK

- [ ] Every company on the list already shows evidence of hiring remotely.
- [ ] Every problem was observed from public information.

DAY 12 Write every message you will need

OBJECTIVE Never compose an important message while stressed.

TASK Save the direct application email, the LinkedIn note, the follow-ups, the dropped-connection message and the thank-you note from Sections 05 and 06 into one notes file, with your own details filled in.

EXAMPLE A single note titled "Application messages", with five labelled blocks.

OUTPUT One notes file, ready to copy from, on your phone.

CHECK

- [ ] Every placeholder is replaced with your real details.
- [ ] You could send any of the five in under two minutes.

DAY 13 Rehearse the interview and test the technology

OBJECTIVE Say your answers out loud before you are graded on them.

TASK Write four STAR stories using Section 6.3. Record your 60-second introduction on your phone and watch it twice. Test camera, microphone and the connection in your chosen room, including in the 16:00 to 24:00 window.

EXAMPLE Stories: a deadline that nearly slipped; a mistake you reported early; a time you learned something fast; a disagreement you handled.

OUTPUT Four written stories, one recording, one tested room.

CHECK

- [ ] Each story has a result with a number in it.
- [ ] Your introduction runs to about 60 seconds, not three minutes.

DAY 14 Build the reliability system and review

OBJECTIVE	Finish every asset and start the application phase with nothing missing.
TASK	Charge both power banks. Set every document to available offline. Write the one-page backup plan from 8.5. Write your overlap window from the table in 8.2. Then run the Section 3.9 checks on the CV and count what you have built.
EXAMPLE	Backup plan on one page next to the desk: network order, phone number, who to message, what to say.
OUTPUT	CV, LinkedIn, portfolio with three samples, tracker with twenty companies, five saved messages, four stories, one backup plan.
CHECK	☐ Every item on the list exists as a file or a saved link, not as an intention. ☐ You know your overlap window in Addis time and in the employer's time.

10.5 The 30-day application plan

About 45 minutes a day: roughly 30 minutes applying, 15 minutes on follow-ups, community contribution and review. One rest day a week is built in and is not optional. This plan is designed to produce **at least 20 high-quality applications** in 30 days; a reader who keeps to every day will land higher.

DAY 01 Start, and send the first one

OBJECTIVE	Break the freeze. The first application is the hardest and the least important.
TASK	Pick the newest posting on your list. Run the 12-minute method from 5.7, send it, log it, set the day-4 follow-up.
EXAMPLE	One application sent by 45 minutes, including the rewrite of the CV summary.
OUTPUT	1 application in the tracker with a next action date.
CHECK	☐ The tracker row is complete, including the posting link.

DAY 02 Two applications

OBJECTIVE	Get faster at the 12-minute method by repeating it twice.
TASK	Two board applications, newest first. Time each one and write the times down.
EXAMPLE	15 minutes and 12 minutes. The second was faster because the wording was already saved.
OUTPUT	3 applications total.
CHECK	☐ Both are logged, both have a follow-up date.

DAY 03 One application, two community answers

OBJECTIVE	Start being visible where remote roles are actually discussed.
TASK	One application, then answer two questions in your professional communities using knowledge you actually have. No requests, no self-promotion.
EXAMPLE	A short answer about how you handle a refund request when the policy is unclear.
OUTPUT	4 applications total; two contributions posted.
CHECK	☐ Neither answer asks for anything.

DAY 04 Two applications, and trim the target list

OBJECTIVE	Learn which postings are worth your time and which are not.
TASK	Two applications. Remove from your list any posting that names an employment country you cannot satisfy, and note why.
EXAMPLE	"Remote (US only), employee contract" — removed, ineligible on two counts.
OUTPUT	6 applications total; a cleaner list.
CHECK	☐ You removed at least one posting rather than applying anyway.

DAY 05 One direct application

OBJECTIVE	Use route B for the first time and see how different it feels.
TASK	Choose one company from your twenty. Send the direct email from 5.9 to a named person, referencing the specific problem you observed.
EXAMPLE	"Your help centre's refund article still refers to a 30-day window; the pricing page says 14."
OUTPUT	7 applications total, one of them direct.
CHECK	☐ The problem you named is real and publicly visible. ☐ You sent one email, not three.

DAY 06 One application, one referral conversation

OBJECTIVE	Open route C without asking for a job.
TASK	One application, then message one person in a community with the connection note from 5.9, asking for nothing.
EXAMPLE	"I am not asking you for a referral. I would like to stay connected in case something relevant opens."
OUTPUT	8 applications; one new professional connection request sent.
CHECK	☐ The note contains no request for a job or a referral.

DAY 07 Week one review. No applications today

OBJECTIVE Read your own data before you repeat the week.

TASK Count applications by route. Note which route produced a reply, a view or nothing. Adjust next week's mix. Rest.

EXAMPLE Six board, two direct. One direct got a same-day reply. Next week: two direct for every three board.

OUTPUT A one-line decision about next week's mix.

CHECK ☐ You wrote down a decision, not only a count.

DAY 08 Two applications, best route only

OBJECTIVE Put more effort into the route that is working.

TASK Two applications using the mix you decided on day 7. If direct is working, both are direct.

EXAMPLE Two direct emails to companies on your list, each naming a different observed problem.

OUTPUT 10 applications total.

CHECK ☐ Your tracker shows a deliberate route mix, not accident.

DAY 09 First follow-ups

OBJECTIVE Run the day-4 follow-up for the first time.

TASK Send the day-4 follow-up, in the employer's time zone, to everything applied to four days ago. Add one new thing to each message. Then one new application.

EXAMPLE "Since sending it I finished a sample that matches the `[task]` in your posting."

OUTPUT All due follow-ups sent; 11 applications total.

CHECK ☐ Every follow-up adds something, rather than asking "any update?".

DAY 10 Two applications

OBJECTIVE Keep volume up on a day with nothing exciting happening.

TASK Two applications. This is a maintenance day, and maintenance days are what the 20-application rule is actually made of.

EXAMPLE Two board applications, both sent inside the first 48 hours of the posting.

OUTPUT 13 applications total.

CHECK ☐ Both postings were published within the last two days.

DAY 11 Day-11 follow-ups and one application

OBJECTIVE Make a second touch that offers something small to say yes to.

TASK Send the day-11 follow-up to the first batch, offering a short paid test task or a 15-minute call. Then one application.

EXAMPLE "If a short paid test task would help you decide, I can start this week."

OUTPUT 14 applications total; second-touch follow-ups sent.

CHECK
- [ ] Each follow-up contains a specific, small next step.

DAY 12 One application, one direct, one contribution

OBJECTIVE Run all three routes in a single day and feel the difference in effort.

TASK One board application, one direct email, and one genuinely useful contribution in a community.

EXAMPLE A post sharing the support reply templates you built on day 7, with a note on what you learned writing them.

OUTPUT 16 applications total.

CHECK
- [ ] The shared material is labelled as a sample, not presented as client work.

DAY 13 One application and a tracker clean-up

OBJECTIVE Make sure nothing is silently rotting in your pipeline.

TASK One application. Then open every row with no reply and a next action date in the past, and either act on it or close it.

EXAMPLE Four rows closed as "no reply after four touches". Two rows given a follow-up today.

OUTPUT 17 applications total; a tracker where every row has a live next action.

CHECK
- [ ] No row is older than 21 days without a decision.

DAY 14 Week two review. No applications today

OBJECTIVE Check whether the role you chose is the role the market is answering.

TASK Count replies by role. If your primary role has produced nothing after nine applications and your backup has produced two replies, switch your effort weighting. Update the CV summary for the backup role. Rest.

EXAMPLE Primary support: 6 sent, 0 replies. Backup data entry: 3 sent, 2 replies. Week three: two thirds on the backup.

OUTPUT A written decision about role weighting for week three.

CHECK ☐ The decision is based on replies, not on preference.

DAY 15 Two applications on the weighted role

OBJECTIVE Put your effort where the evidence points.

TASK Two applications for the role that produced replies last week. Rewrite the CV summary for that role before you send anything.

EXAMPLE Summary rewritten from "customer support assistant" to "data-entry and records assistant" with the accuracy figure moved to the front.

OUTPUT 19 applications total; a second tailored CV variant saved.

CHECK ☐ The new CV variant is still one page.

DAY 16 One application and all due follow-ups

OBJECTIVE Keep the follow-up cadence running without letting it eat the day.

TASK One application, then every follow-up due today by the day 4, 11 and 21 rules. Cap the follow-up block at 15 minutes.

EXAMPLE Three day-4 notes and one day-21 closing note, all sent in twelve minutes.

OUTPUT 20 applications total — the challenge target reached on day 16.

CHECK ☐ Nothing has received more than three follow-ups.

DAY 17 Two applications

OBJECTIVE Pass 20 rather than stopping at it.

TASK Two applications. Twenty is the minimum at which the data becomes useful, not the finish line.

EXAMPLE Two mid-sized companies that hire contractors in several countries.

OUTPUT 22 applications total.

CHECK ☐ Both were tailored, not copy-paste.

DAY 18 One application, one direct, one interview drill

OBJECTIVE	Stay interview-ready, because replies arrive in clusters.
TASK	One application and one direct email. Then re-record your 60-second introduction and watch it once.
EXAMPLE	Second recording is thirty seconds shorter than the first.
OUTPUT	24 applications total; a tighter introduction.
CHECK	☐ You can deliver the introduction without reading it.

DAY 19 One application and a salary rehearsal

OBJECTIVE	Be able to name a number calmly, out loud.
TASK	One application. Then say your three salary numbers aloud ten times, and rehearse asking for their budget first, using the script in 6.6.
EXAMPLE	"Could you tell me the range budgeted for this position?" — said without hesitation, ten times.
OUTPUT	25 applications total; three numbers written down.
CHECK	☐ Each number is stated with a currency and a period.

DAY 20 One application and a payment-route question

OBJECTIVE	Find out early which employers can actually pay you.
TASK	One application. Then ask the payment question from Section 06 of any employer who has replied, and record the answer in the tracker.
EXAMPLE	"We pay contractors through a licensed transfer operator and we cover the fee." Recorded in column 8.
OUTPUT	26 applications total; at least one payment answer recorded.
CHECK	☐ Column 8 is no longer empty for any active conversation.

DAY 21 Week three review and the quiet close

OBJECTIVE	End conversations that have gone nowhere and free the attention for live ones.
TASK	Send the day-21 closing note to everything applied to three weeks ago. Mark those rows closed in the tracker. Count replies by route for the month. Rest.
EXAMPLE	"I am still interested, and I am also applying elsewhere, so I wanted to close the loop rather than keep chasing."
OUTPUT	A shortlist of live conversations and a clean tracker.
CHECK	☐ No closed row will receive another message.

DAY 22 Two applications, refreshed list

OBJECTIVE	Replace the ten companies you have already written to.
TASK	Add ten new companies to your list, each with an observed problem. Then two applications.
EXAMPLE	A company whose careers page lists remote roles in four countries, with a support page last updated two years ago.
OUTPUT	28 applications total; twenty active target companies.
CHECK	☐ Every new company shows evidence of hiring remotely.

DAY 23 One application and a client conversion

OBJECTIVE	Keep route D alive while you run the other three.
TASK	One application. Then send the retainer pitch from 10.2 to any client who has paid you twice or more.
EXAMPLE	Four articles a month, one brief call, two revision rounds, invoiced on the 1st.
OUTPUT	29 applications total; one retainer pitch sent.
CHECK	☐ The pitch names a scope, a monthly figure and a rhythm.

DAY 24 One application, one direct, one test task

OBJECTIVE	Be ready to deliver a test task within 48 hours of it arriving.
TASK	One application and one direct email. Then take one of your sample projects and reformat it as a test-task delivery: a folder, a clear file name and a short plain-language README.
EXAMPLE	Folder "Test task — support reply pack", containing the deliverable, a one-page summary and the assumptions you made.
OUTPUT	31 applications total; a reusable test-task delivery format.
CHECK	☐ A stranger could review the delivery in five minutes.

DAY 25 One application, and one polite withdrawal

OBJECTIVE Protect your time from processes that are not real.

TASK One application. Then withdraw from any process that has asked for unpaid work beyond a short test, or for money, or for documents before an interview.

EXAMPLE "I can complete a two-hour version unpaid, or the full version as a paid task."

OUTPUT 32 applications total; at least one process closed on your terms.

CHECK ☐ You withdrew in writing, politely, with a reason.

DAY 26 One application and community contribution

OBJECTIVE Keep route C warm, because it produces results late.

TASK One application. Then answer two questions and share one thing you learned during the last three weeks.

EXAMPLE A short post on what changed in your reply rate when you switched from board applications to direct emails — with the honest caveat that it is one person's month.

OUTPUT 33 applications total.

CHECK ☐ The post claims no result that you cannot show.

DAY 27 One application and all due follow-ups

OBJECTIVE Finish the month with nothing unattended.

TASK One application, then every follow-up due today. Check that no conversation has gone past three follow-ups.

EXAMPLE Two day-4 notes, one day-11 note offering a paid test, one day-21 close.

OUTPUT 34 applications total; the tracker fully current.

CHECK ☐ Every row has a next action date in the future or a closed status.

DAY 28 Week four review. No applications today

OBJECTIVE	Decide, from evidence, what the next 30 days should look like.
TASK	Total applications by route, replies by route, interviews, tests and offers. Identify the single change with the largest effect. Rest.
EXAMPLE	34 sent, 5 replies, 2 interviews, both from direct emails. Next month: direct becomes the primary route.
OUTPUT	A written plan for days 31 to 60, one page.
CHECK	☐ The plan changes what you do, not only how you describe it.

DAY 29 Two applications on the new weighting

OBJECTIVE	Begin the next cycle before the current one ends.
TASK	Two applications using the route you decided on day 28. If direct is the answer, both are direct.
EXAMPLE	Two direct emails, each naming a specific problem at a company that hires contractors internationally.
OUTPUT	36 applications total.
CHECK	☐ Both follow the format that produced your interviews.

DAY 30 Count, decide, continue

OBJECTIVE	Close the month honestly and set the next target.
TASK	Count total applications sent and logged. Compare against 20. Write down what you will change, and set the next 30-day target. If you have interviews in progress, prepare for them using Section 06 rather than starting new applications.
EXAMPLE	"36 sent. Below my target of 40 because I lost week two to power cuts. Next month I will batch two applications before 16:00 each day."
OUTPUT	A number, an honest explanation, and a next target.
CHECK	☐ Every application in your count has a tracker row. ☐ You have written the next target down.

10.6 After day 30

Thirty days of applications is not the end of a search, it is one cycle of one. Some readers will have an interview by day 20 and an offer by day 45. Others will send sixty applications across two cycles before a reply. Both are normal, and neither is a verdict on you.

— **Keep the 45-minute habit** whether or not anything is landing. The habit is the asset; the replies are the output.

— **Change one variable per cycle** — the role, the route, the opening line of the application, or the region you target. Changing three at once teaches you nothing.

— **Do not drop the freelance and retainer work** while you search. Income, references and evidence all come from it, and route D is still the most likely way you get hired.
— **Re-read Sections 03 and 04 every six weeks.** Your proof improves as you work, and your CV should show it.

CLOSING

Common Mistakes, and the Fix for Each

These are the twelve errors that cost local applicants remote roles they could have done well. Each one has a fix you can apply this week.

MISTAKE	THE FIX
1. Applying to roles you cannot be paid for. The posting says remote, so you apply, and only later discover it is a US-only employee role.	Read the eligibility paragraph before anything else. Filter for roles open to independent contractors worldwide, and check whether the region list includes Africa or "anywhere".
2. A CV built for a local reader. Two columns, a photo, date of birth, and bullets that start with "Responsible for".	Single column, one page, no photo, no personal details, and every bullet rewritten as an outcome with a number.
3. Waiting until you feel ready. Three weeks of revising a CV and not one application sent.	Apply on day 8 of the plan in Section 10. Readiness is a set of files, not a feeling, and your first ten applications are practice.
4. Using only job boards. Twenty board applications, zero replies, and the conclusion that remote work does not work for locals.	Run all four routes. Direct applications and client conversion produce replies that boards rarely do.
5. Samples that look like client work. A portfolio that implies you were hired when you were not.	Label every sample with the standard wording in Section 4.7. One extra line removes the entire risk.
6. Not asking how you will be paid. The offer arrives, the employer asks for your payment details, and the conversation collapses.	Ask in the first interview: how do you pay contractors outside your country, and who covers the transfer fee? Record the answer in your tracker.

MISTAKE	THE FIX
7. Naming a salary number first, and low. Asked for expectations, you say a figure below the budget and set your own ceiling.	Ask for their budgeted range first. If pushed, give a researched range with a currency and a period, and rehearse it out loud ten times before the call.
8. No backup plan for the connection. The call drops, you rejoin twice, and you never hear from them again.	Second SIM, hotspot, a neighbour's line arranged in advance, an agreed phone number, and a written summary to send within ten minutes. Tell the interviewer the plan before the interview starts.
9. Going silent when something goes wrong. You miss a deadline and hope nobody notices.	Send the five-line delay warning from Section 07 the moment you know: what happened, what it affects, what you did, what you need, the new date.

MISTAKE	THE FIX
10. Chasing too hard. Six follow-ups, messages at the weekend, and a follow-up on a channel the employer never used.	Four touches maximum — day 4, day 11, day 21, then stop. Send on working days in the employer's time zone.

MISTAKE	THE FIX
11. Paying to be hired. An equipment deposit, a training fee, a "registration" charge, a visa fee.	No legitimate employer charges you to be hired. Stop the conversation, keep the messages, and read the anti-scam section that follows.

MISTAKE	THE FIX
12. Treating the first rejection as a verdict. One no reply and the whole system is abandoned.	Twenty applications before you draw any conclusion, and change one variable per cycle. Twenty applications do not guarantee an interview — but ten tell you almost nothing.

CLOSING

Questions local Applicants Actually Ask

Will companies hire someone where you live?

Some will, some will not, and you cannot tell which from the outside. Companies that already hire independent contractors across many countries are the realistic target. Companies that hire employees under one country's employment law are usually closed to you, not because of your ability but because of their paperwork. This is exactly why **no verified list of employers who hire where you live exists** — the answer changes monthly, so the course teaches the search instead.

Do I need perfect English?

No. You need clear written English and enough spoken English to hold a work conversation. Many remote roles are almost entirely written. What fails is not accent or grammar — it is ambiguity, silence and pretending to understand something you did not. Section 07 gives you the three sentences that fix that.

Can I work remotely with 9 Mbps?

Yes, for most roles. The published median fixed download speed was 9.37 Mbps, which handles documents, tickets, chat and video calls. The problem is not the average, it is the worst case: freelancer speeds reported as low as 98 Kb/s between 16:00 and 24:00. Plan for text-first work, offline copies, and a backup connection for anything with a fixed time.

Do I need a degree?

For some roles, yes — many employers list one as a filter, and there is nothing you can do about that except apply anyway or target employers that do not. For data entry, social-media assistance, appointment setting and social-media work, a portfolio and a test task often carry more weight than the certificate. For developer roles, a repository with finished, documented projects is frequently read more carefully than a transcript.

How do I handle the time difference?

your city is UTC+3 with no daylight saving. Put your overlap window in your CV summary, your LinkedIn About section and your first message. Target Europe, the Gulf and East Africa where the overlap is comfortable, and treat US West Coast roles as asynchronous or night work. The worked table is in Section 8.2.

What if my power goes out during a meeting?

Keep two charged power banks, join everything from a charged laptop with the charger plugged in, and tell the interviewer your plan before the call begins. If you drop out, rejoin once, then switch to audio via phone, then send the written summary from Section 6.9 within ten minutes. A prepared person who drops once is remembered far better than an unprepared person who never does.

How do I get paid?

Through your regulator-licensed remittance corridor: your employer sends through a licensed money-transfer operator, the sender pays the transfer fee and the exchange spread, and you receive dollars as cash, bank deposit or wallet credit. There is **no verified direct PayPal, Payoneer, Wise or Stripe receiving rail** for a resident of a country with limited payment access — verify anything before you rely on it. The registered upgrade path is TIN, then business licence, then service-exporter registration, which under service-export rules allows 100% indefinite retention of foreign-currency earnings and an international card. Section 09 has the detail.

Do I need a laptop?

For five of the ten roles, effectively yes: designer, developer, researcher, virtual assistant, and most customer-support work. Data entry, social-media assistance, appointment setting by message and part of content writing can be done on a phone. Every section of this course says which one it is describing, rather than assuming a laptop you may not have.

How long does it take to get hired?

Anyone who gives you a number is guessing. What this course will tell you is the shape: about 14 days to build every asset, then application cycles of 30 days. Some readers will interview in the first cycle. Some will need three. The variable you control is applications sent and logged — the rest is the market.

Should I lie about my location?

No, and never. Not on a form, not in a profile, not in a contract. It collapses the moment money moves, it is misrepresentation, and it can turn a rejection into a legal problem. Your location is also the source of your real advantage: an overlapping time zone with Europe, the Gulf and East Africa, and English that works.

What about tax?

This book is not tax advice. What is verified: a TIN is mandatory where you live, turnover tax under your country's turnover-tax rules is 2% on goods sold locally and 10% on other services, records are to be kept for ten years under the VAT Proclamation No. 285/2002, and VAT registration may be cancelled where 12-month taxable transactions are expected to be at or below $500,000. Presumptive or Category C rules could not be verified here — confirm your category at your local tax office, or with your national tax authority.

Is remote work legal where you live?

Working for a foreign employer as an independent contractor is not prohibited, and the state provides a registration path for service exporters.

What is prohibited is specific: virtual-asset activity unless expressly authorised, unlicensed money remittance, and misrepresenting your residency to obtain financial services.

Earn through licensed channels, register when your income justifies it, pay your tax, and keep your records. If your situation is complicated, ask a professional rather than a group chat.

What if nobody replies?

Then you have data, not a failure. Open the tracker and look at replies by route. If direct emails produced replies and boards produced none, change the mix. If nothing produced replies after twenty tailored applications, change the role, not the effort. Silence is information.

Is this a scam?

This book is not selling you a job, a list or a guarantee, so it has nothing to gain from your believing one exists. The scams are elsewhere — in the messages that arrive offering you a role you did not apply for. The next section shows you exactly what those look like.

CLOSING

How to Spot a Fake Remote Job

Remote job fraud targets people who are qualified, motivated and far from the employer — which describes you. The patterns are consistent, and they are learnable in ten minutes.

The seven patterns

01 Pay for your equipment

You are hired, then asked to pay a supplier for a laptop, a headset or software, with a promise of reimbursement in your first salary. The supplier is the scam. **No legitimate employer asks you to pay to be hired.**

02 Fake HR accounts on Telegram and WhatsApp

A recruiter contacts you on a messaging app with a company name and a logo. Real processes start from a company domain email and a company careers page. Verify the person on the company's own website before you reply.

03 Identity documents before an interview

You are asked for a passport scan, a national ID, a selfie holding your ID, or bank details before anyone has interviewed you. A legitimate employer collects documents after an offer, through a proper process.

04 A fee for visa sponsorship

Nobody charges a candidate for sponsorship. If a "sponsor" wants a fee, a deposit or a "processing" payment, stop. This is one of the most common cross-border job scams.

05 Cheque-cashing and money-mule offers

You are sent money, asked to keep a share and forward the rest, or asked to receive payments on the company's behalf. This is money laundering, and the account that gets closed will be yours. It is also unlicensed money remittance, which is illegal and punishable where you live.

06 Salary offered in crypto

Virtual-asset activity is prohibited where you live unless expressly authorised. A "salary" in crypto is not a payment route — it is a compliance problem with your name attached, and it is often a way to pay you in something you cannot convert.

07 The one-time code request

Someone claiming to be from a platform's security team asks for a password or a one-time code to "verify" you or to "recover" your account. **No legitimate platform, bank or employer ever asks for a one-time code.** This exact account-takeover pattern has been documented where you liven press, where scammers posing as Telegram security staff harvested passwords and codes, seized accounts, and then asked the victim's contacts for money.

What the your central bank or financial regulator says

The your regulator has issued a public warning that fraudsters impersonate people on WhatsApp, Telegram, Facebook, email, SMS and in fake phone calls to request urgent transfers. The warning sits under your regulator Proclamation 1359/2025 Article 6(28) and the your financial-consumer-protection rules. If you are targeted, report it to `your regulator's complaint address` or to `6230`. Keep the messages and the account details you were given — a screenshot is evidence, and deleting the conversation destroys it.

THREE RULES THAT COVER ALMOST EVERYTHING

- **No legitimate employer asks you to pay to be hired.** Not for equipment, not for training, not for a visa, not for registration, not for a background check.
- **No legitimate person or platform asks for your one-time code or password.** Ever, for any reason, including "security".
- **No legitimate employer needs your bank details, ID documents or a selfie with your ID before an interview.** Documents come after an offer, through a proper process.

The eight-point legitimacy checklist

Run this before you reply to anything that arrives unexpectedly. If you cannot tick six or more, stop.

- [ ] The role is advertised on the company's own careers page, not only in a message.
- [ ] The person contacting you has a company email address on the company's real domain.
- [ ] The person and the role appear on the company's website or LinkedIn page.
- [ ] The interview happens on a normal video call, with a named human, not only in text.
- [ ] Nobody has asked you for money, in any form, at any stage.
- [ ] Nobody has asked for a one-time code, a password, or access to your accounts.
- [ ] No identity documents or bank details have been requested before an interview.
- [ ] The pay is stated in a normal currency, through a licensed channel, and the transfer fee has been discussed.

If you have already been caught

1. Stop all payments immediately, including any that are "almost complete".

1. Change your passwords on every account you used, starting with your email, and turn on two-step verification everywhere.

1. Tell your bank or wallet provider the same day. Speed matters more than embarrassment.

1. Report to your regulator at `your regulator's complaint address` or `6230`, and to the police if money has been taken.
2. Tell the people in your contacts. If your account was taken over, they will be messaged next.
3. Do not pay anyone who offers to recover the money for a fee. That is a second scam aimed at the same person.

Sources & Further Reading

Every platform figure in this book traces to one of the sources below, all checked in September 2026. Platform country lists, payout methods and fees change often — confirm anything you intend to rely on at the source itself.

1. Gumroad — pricing and fee structure — https://gumroad.com/pricing
2. Gumroad — getting paid, bank-payout country list and payout schedule — https://gumroad.com/help/article/13-getting-paid
3. Gumroad — fees in detail — https://gumroad.com/help/article/66-gumroads-fees
4. Gumroad — payout settings, identity documents and tax IDs — https://gumroad.com/help/article/260-your-payout-settings-page
5. Gumroad — account suspension and what causes it — https://gumroad.com/help/article/160-suspension
6. Gumroad — terms of service (identity, location and account rules) — https://gumroad.com/terms
7. Lemon Squeezy — supported countries for sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/supported-countries
8. Lemon Squeezy — W-8 and W-9 tax forms for non-US sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/tax-forms/w8-w9-forms
9. Lemon Squeezy — pricing — https://www.lemonsqueezy.com/pricing
10. Stripe — cross-border payouts and supported regions — https://docs.stripe.com/connect/cross-border-payouts
11. IRS — About Form W-8BEN — https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-w-8-ben
12. IRS — United States income tax treaties A to Z — https://www.irs.gov/businesses/international-businesses/united-states-income-tax-treaties-a-to-z
13. Whop — payout methods and countries — https://docs.whop.com/manage-your-business/manage-payouts/payout-methods
14. Payhip — how sellers get paid — https://help.payhip.com/article/173-how-do-i-get-paid
15. Ko-fi — how creators get paid — https://help.ko-fi.com/hc/en-us/articles/115003980093-How-do-I-get-paid
16. Fungies — countries you can sell from — https://fungies.io/global-availability/
17. Telegram — Telegram Stars for digital goods — https://telegram.org/blog/telegram-stars
18. Google — Business Profile supported countries — https://support.google.com/business/answer/6270107
19. YouTube — Partner Program availability by country — https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/7101720
20. DataReportal — global digital statistics — https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-global-overview-report
21. World Bank — World Development Indicators — https://databank.worldbank.org/source/world-development-indicators
22. International Labour Organization — ILOSTAT employment data — https://ilostat.ilo.org/
23. Internet Society — Internet shutdown and disruption reporting — https://www.internetsociety.org/
24. FATF — virtual asset and payment-service guidance by jurisdiction — https://www.fatf-gafi.org/

Where research could not verify a fact, this book says so in the text and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

CLOSING

The Final Checklist

Work down this list before you send your first application. If you cannot tick an item, that item is today's task.

Before you apply

- [ ] I have chosen one primary role and one backup role, in writing.
- [ ] My CV is one page in a single column, with no photo and no personal details.
- [ ] My summary line names the role, one measurable result and my overlap window in Addis time.
- [ ] Every CV bullet has a number, a tool, a duration or a result.
- [ ] My degree, national service, family business role and volunteer work are all translated into plain work language.
- [ ] My gaps are explained in one line each, and I have a spoken answer ready.
- [ ] My CV file is named Firstname-Lastname-CV.pdf and opens correctly on a phone.
- [ ] My LinkedIn headline, About, photo, location and open-to-work settings are all done.
- [ ] My location on LinkedIn and on every form says my real city and your country.
- [ ] I have a work-only email address with two-step verification and a four-line signature.
- [ ] My portfolio folder is view-only, opens on mobile data, and starts with a one-page index.
- [ ] All three sample projects exist and every one carries the standard sample label.
- [ ] I have one piece of real pro-bono or volunteer work with permission to describe it.
- [ ] I have a documented personal project written up honestly.
- [ ] Every template I need is saved in one notes file with my details filled in.
- [ ] My tracker has all twelve columns and at least twenty target companies.
- [ ] I know my overlap window for at least three employer regions.
- [ ] My interview room, camera, microphone and light have all been tested at the right hour.
- [ ] I have four STAR stories written, each with a result that contains a number.
- [ ] I can deliver my 60-second introduction without reading it.
- [ ] I have two charged power banks and a second SIM topped up.
- [ ] Every document I need is set to available offline.
- [ ] My one-page backup plan is written and next to my desk.
- [ ] I know my salary floor, my fair figure and my ask, all with a currency and a period.
- [ ] I know how to ask for the employer's budgeted range before naming a number.
- [ ] I know the question I will ask about how they pay contractors abroad.
- [ ] I know the three rules that protect me from job fraud, and your regulator reporting address.

FINAL CHALLENGE

Final Challenge: Apply to 20 Remote Opportunities

This is the challenge the whole course has been building towards. Not read it. Do it.

Within 30 days of finishing this book, send and log **20 high-quality applications** for remote roles that match your primary or backup role from Section 02. Twenty is the working target from Section 5.6, and it is the point at which your own data becomes more useful than anyone's advice, including this book's.

What counts as one high-quality application

- [ ] The role genuinely matches my primary or backup role.
- [ ] I read the whole posting, including the eligibility paragraph, before applying.
- [ ] The top third of my CV and my summary line were rewritten for this posting.
- [ ] I used the employer's own nouns where they are true of me.
- [ ] I answered every knockout question honestly, including country and time zone.
- [ ] I attached exactly one correctly named PDF.
- [ ] Where a human contact existed, I sent one short separate message.
- [ ] The row in my tracker is complete, including the posting link.
- [ ] The next action date is set.
- [ ] I can describe the role and the company from memory a week later.

Your tracking sheet

Twelve columns, updated the same day, on your phone. Copy the structure from Section 5.5 exactly. Do not add columns; twelve is already more than you will use honestly.

Applications sent and logged	.....
Of those, sent directly to a company	.....
Follow-ups sent on schedule	.....
Replies received	.....
Interviews held	.....
Test tasks completed	.....
The one change I will make next cycle	.....

READ THIS BEFORE YOU START COUNTING

Twenty applications do not guarantee an interview, an offer or a reply. This course will not tell you what percentage to expect, because the number depends on your role, your proof, your English, your overlap, the market that month and chance. What twenty applications guarantee is that you will have real data about your own search instead of a guess. That is the whole promise.

HOW TO KNOW YOU HAVE FINISHED THE CHALLENGE

Twenty rows in the tracker, each one complete, each one a role you could actually do, each one tailored rather than copied. If your tracker shows twenty rows and you cannot remember half of them, you sent twenty clicks, not twenty applications. Start again from Section 5.6 and count only the ones that pass the list above.

CLOSING

Next Steps

Whichever way your first cycle goes, there is a next move. Pick the one that matches what you learned.

02 The local Freelancer Starter System

Read this if you would rather sell services than hold a job. It covers finding clients, pricing in dollars and dollars, delivering work, and keeping a client past the first project — the route D mechanics in Section 10, at full length. Many readers run both: freelance income for cash flow, applications for stability.

03 AI Income for locals

Read this if the roles you wanted kept asking for a skill you do not have yet. It adds in-demand AI-assisted skills to what you already do — drafting, research, summarising, basic automation — which raises both your application quality and your rate.

09 The local Online Service Business

Read this if local businesses kept asking you for work while you were applying abroad. It builds local recurring revenue — clients who pay in dollars, on a monthly cycle — which funds your data, your equipment and your time while the remote search continues.

10 The 30-Day Digital Business Challenge

Read this when you want the full build in one structured month, with the plans, the trackers and the reviews in a single sequence. It is the natural next step once you have finished the 20-application challenge and know which parts of the system you actually use.

THE ORDER THAT WORKS FOR MOST READERS

Finish the 14-day plan in Section 10 and start the 30-day application cycle. If replies are slow by day 20, add Course 03 skills to widen the roles you can apply for. If you need income sooner than a hiring process allows, add Course 02 or Course 09 alongside — not instead. Nothing in this book requires you to choose one path permanently.

CLOSING

Disclaimer

Educational material only. This course teaches a process. It does not provide employment, recruitment, agency or placement services, and it does not guarantee a job, an interview, a reply, a contract, a salary or any particular income.

Examples are illustrative. Every business, employer, applicant and figure presented as an example in this book is fictional and labelled as such. Nothing in this course should be read as a claim about any real company, or as a statement that any named company hires where you live.

Figures and sources. All statistics, rates, limits and legal references are current as at September 2026 and are drawn from the sources listed in the Sources section. Exchange rates, wallet limits, licensing lists, platform availability and legal requirements change. Verify anything you intend to rely on.

Not legal, tax, financial or immigration advice. Nothing here is a substitute for advice from a qualified professional or from the relevant local authority. You are responsible for complying with local law, tax rules and reporting obligations, for the rules of any platform you use, and for the requirements of any payment provider or employer you deal with. Where this book describes a registration path or a tax rule, confirm the current position with your national tax authority, the your central bank or financial regulator or your bank before you act on it.

No guarantees, and no shortcuts. This course does not teach, endorse or support misrepresenting your location or residency, using a VPN to obtain a financial account you are not eligible for, renting or borrowing another person's account or identity, accepting payment in virtual assets, or acting as an unlicensed remittance channel. Those are described in Section 09 only so that you can recognise and avoid them.

Your responsibility. Your outcome depends on your skills, your proof, your English, your available hours, your time-zone overlap, the employers you approach and the market on the day you apply. Nobody can promise you a result, and this book does not.

GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

The Remote Work Starter System

How to Build a Remote-Ready Profile and Find Online Work From Anywhere

COPYRIGHT, DISCLAIMER AND HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

Read This Page Before You Apply Anywhere

The Remote Work Starter System — How to Build a Remote-Ready Profile and Find Online Work From your country. First Edition · September 2026.

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was researched, written and edited by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It carries no individual author name and no personal credentials, because the value of the book is the method, not a personality.

Edition: First Edition · September 2026. Copyright in this edition rests with NexKit your country. Please do not redistribute the file. If a friend needs it, send them to the shop, not the PDF.

What this course is

A practical, your country-specific manual for becoming employable by a company that will never meet you in person. It maps ten remote roles against the skills you already have, shows how to write a CV and profile that survive an automated first screen, how to build proof when you have no remote experience, how to apply directly instead of only through job boards, how to handle a video interview on an unreliable connection, how to work across time zones, and exactly how money reaches a resident of a country with limited payment access when a foreign employer pays.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of a job, an interview or a reply. It is not legal, tax, immigration or financial advice. It is not a list of employers who hire where you live, because that list changes weekly and no verified version of it exists. It does not guarantee a visa, a contract, a salary or a payout method.

DISCLAIMER — READ THIS ONCE, PROPERLY

This course is **educational material only**. Nothing in it is a guarantee of income, and nothing in it is financial, legal or investment advice.

Any salary, rate or income figure in this book is a **target example or published benchmark, never a prediction about you**. local job advertisements frequently publish no salary at all, and where this book gives a range it says whether that range is published data or an estimate. Your outcome depends on your skills, your proof, your English, your time zone overlap, the employer and the market on the day you apply.

All prices, rates and ladders shown in this book are **illustrative examples** for teaching. You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of any platform you use, and the requirements of any bank, wallet or payment provider you deal with. Rules, fees, limits and country availability change, sometimes quickly.

Where the underlying research could not verify a fact, this book says so and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

DATES, CURRENCY AND EXAMPLES

All money in this course is US US dollars (USD), written as $25. Where a United States dollar figure appears it states its rate and its date on the same line.

Every business named anywhere in these pages is invented. Each is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. No real, recognisable local company is presented as a client, a case study or a testimonial.

Every figure cited is current as of **September 2026** unless a different date is printed beside it. Source URLs for those figures appear in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the back of the book.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON ANY OF THIS

Payment limits, wallet rules, tax thresholds and platform availability are the parts of this book most likely to go stale. Treat every number as a starting point for your own check, not as a substitute for it. Where this book names a rule, confirm the current version with the institution that made it.

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

01 · The Remote-Work Reality for locals 11
02 · Choose Your Role From Your Skills 15
03 · The Remote-Ready CV 20
04 · Your Professional Profile and Proof 28
05 · Finding and Applying to Remote Work 34
06 · The Remote Interview 42
07 · Remote Work Etiquette and Communication 50
08 · Time Zones, Schedule and Reliability 58
09 · Getting Paid by a Foreign Employer 64
10 · From Freelance to Remote, and the Two Plans 70

HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.